PM Dev · Artifact #1

Problem Statement

Problem Statement	v1.0	You	April 2026	Approved

STATEMENT

> A professional with ADHD and strong product vision needs a structured, low-overwhelm system for executing software projects from idea to deployment — because the gap between ideation and execution has historically prevented completion and eroded confidence. Today no personal workflow exists that accounts for their cognitive wiring, making every new project feel like starting from scratch. PM Dev is that system: a repeatable, ADHD-informed product development process that produces deployed projects, professional PM artifacts, and growing technical fluency — one project at a time.

KEY COMPONENTS

User	A professional with ADHD and strong product vision
Core Need	A structured, low-overwhelm system for executing software projects
Root Cause	The gap between ideation and execution — no workflow that matches cognitive wiring
What's Broken	Every new project feels like starting from scratch; ideas never become deployed products
The Solution	PM Dev — a repeatable, ADHD-informed product development process
Primary Output	Deployed projects, professional PM artifacts, and growing technical fluency

PM Dev · Artifact #2 · Primary User

Persona #1 — The Visionary Staller

Primary Persona	v1.0	You	April 2026	Approved

CPA / MBA — Aspiring PM — ADHD Systems Thinker

> "I can see the entire product in my head in seconds — fully formed, every feature, every user. Then I open a blank doc and I can't begin."

CORE PAIN POINTS

Idea-to-execution gap	Activation energy paralysis	Overwhelm from scope flood	Fear of judgment
Shame from incompletion	Unknown unknowns anxiety		

COGNITIVE PROFILE

ADHD — fast-burst ideation	Systems thinker	Strong UX intuition	Business fluency (CPA/MBA)
UI — acknowledged gap	Enjoys coding basics		

THE LOOP — WHAT BREAKS EVERY PROJECT

1. Ignition	2. Overwhelm	3. Stall
Dopamine rush, creative flood, everything at once	Can't capture fast enough, momentum fades	No clear step 1, blank page panic, withdrawal

WHAT THIS USER NEEDS FROM PM DEV

Capture speed A way to dump the flood without losing the thread	**Obvious next action** Always one clear, small, named step
Structure without walls Framework that guides, doesn't cage	**Visible progress** Proof that things are moving forward
Forgiveness built in No penalty for pausing and returning	**AI as co-pilot** Reduce unknown unknowns in real time

---

Goal	Definition of Success
Deploy one complete project. Prove execution is possible.	Live portfolio site + documented PM process + confidence to repeat.

PM Dev · Artifact #3 · Secondary User · Portfolio Visitor

Persona #2 — The Hiring Evaluator

Secondary Persona	v1.0	You	April 2026	Approved

Hiring Manager / Recruiter — Evaluating PM or Dev Candidates

> "I have 30 seconds and a stack of portfolios. Show me you understand problems, can ship solutions, and think like a professional — fast."

WHAT THEY'RE SCANNING FOR IN 30 SECONDS

0–10 sec	10–20 sec	20–30 sec
Does this look credible and professional? First visual impression.	Can they define a real problem and articulate a clear solution?	Is there supporting evidence of PM process? Artifacts, documentation, rigor.

THEIR CORE EVALUATION QUESTIONS

Can they ship?	Do they understand users?	Can they communicate clearly?	Do they think in systems?
Is there real business acumen?	Will they require hand-holding?		

WHAT MUST BE VISIBLE IMMEDIATELY

Project interface	A real, deployed, working product — not a mockup labeled 'coming soon'
Problem + solution	Crisp one-paragraph brief — what was broken, what was built, why it matters
PM artifacts	Persona, PRD, user stories — evidence of professional process
Business context	CPA + MBA signals analytical credibility alongside creative work
Growth arc	Multiple projects showing learning curve over time
Contact / next step	Frictionless path to reach out or download resume

---

Their Goal	Portfolio's Job
Quickly determine: is this person worth a conversation?	Answer yes in under 30 seconds. Then give them enough depth to confirm

PM Dev · Artifact #4 · Persona #1 · Moment: Sitting down to start a project

Empathy Map — The Visionary Staller

Empathy Map	v1.0	You	April 2026	Approved

THINKS	FEELS
• "Should I get a dot journal? Learn Figma? Set up GitHub? What's the tech stack?" • "This idea might not even be good the more I think about it." • "This is a jigsaw puzzle with no picture on the box." • "Sixth graders already know more than me about this." • "I need a Sherlock mind palace."	• Foggy stupor — low-grade paralysis before the spark • Euphoric clarity at the POW moment — brief, intense • Overwhelmed immediately after — can't capture fast enough • Shame and self-doubt — 'is this a hobby or a career?' • Physical restlessness — uncomfortable, hungry, can't settle • Excitement and dread simultaneously

SAYS	DOES
• "I need to research each of these competing ideas first." • "Maybe music will help. Maybe a new notebook." • "I should be looking for jobs. My resume is terrible." • "I'm already going down the rabbit hole." • "I don't have enough time — but I'm not doing anything else."	• Opens a Google Doc — writes word salad — edits — loses thread • Spirals into tool research instead of doing the work • Daydreams, gets distracted, eats something • Generates feature ideas mid-task — can't stop the flood • Starts new tangents before finishing current thought • Eventually abandons session — idea stays in head only

PAINS	GAINS SOUGHT
• No single clear starting point — always feels like the middle • Too many tasks visible at once — triggers shutdown • Unknown unknowns feel infinite and threatening • Every tool requires a learning curve before use • No way to capture the burst before it fades • Self-judgment compounds every moment of friction	• One obvious next step — no decision required • A fast capture tool that thinks at burst speed • Visible proof of progress — even tiny increments • Someone (or something) holding the map — so they don't have to • Permission to be in the middle without shame • The fog clearing just enough to take one step

CORE DESIGN INSIGHT EXTRACTED FROM THIS MAP

PM Dev must show exactly one prompt at a time. It must hide the full scope. It must reward the first answer immediately with visible progress. It must provide a safe container for the burst — fast capture without structure — and then organize it quietly in the background.

PM Dev · Artifact #5 · Framework: Christensen JTBD

Jobs-to-be-Done + Design Principles

JTBD + Design Principles	v1.0	You	April 2026	Approved

FUNCTIONAL JOB — WHAT THE SYSTEM MUST DO

"When I have a new product idea, help me capture it fast enough that nothing is lost — and then show me exactly one next step so I don't have to decide where to start."

The functional hire: a structured capture-and-guide system that matches burst speed then slows to execution pace.

EMOTIONAL JOB — WHAT THE USER NEEDS TO FEEL

"When I sit down to work, help me feel like a capable professional who is making real progress — not a distracted dreamer spinning in place."

The emotional hire: the feeling of momentum and professional identity, delivered in small visible increments.

SOCIAL JOB — WHAT THE USER NEEDS TO DEMONSTRATE

"When someone evaluates my work, help me show that I think, document, and deliver like a professional PM — even though I'm still building experience."

The social hire: credible professional artifacts that speak before the candidate does.

ANXIETY JOB — WHAT THE SYSTEM MUST PREVENT

"When I open the system, never show me the full scope of everything that needs to be done — because that is the exact moment the loop starts and nothing gets finished."

The anxiety hire: progressive disclosure. Hide the mountain. Show only the next foothold.

FOUNDING DESIGN PRINCIPLE — THE IGNITION PROMPT

"[Entity] is having an issue with [problem]. How would you solve it?"

Designed to trigger intrinsic motivation through puzzle-framing. Bypasses activation paralysis by appealing to the user's identity as a problem-solver. The answer to this prompt seeds every artifact that follows.

DESIGN PRINCIPLES DERIVED FROM ALL JTBD STATEMENTS

1 **One prompt, one answer, one step**
Never show more than one question or task at a time. The next step only appears after the current one is complete.

2	**Capture first, organize later** During the burst moment, the system accepts raw unstructured input — voice, fragments, lists — and structures it quietly in the background.
3	**Visible progress over hidden work** Every completed step produces a visible artifact — named, versioned, dated. Proof of movement, not just activity.
4	**Progressive disclosure of scope** The full project roadmap exists — but is never shown all at once. Complexity is revealed only when the user is ready for the next layer.
5	**AI holds the map** The user never has to remember where they are, what comes next, or what they've forgotten. The system carries that cognitive load entirely.
6	**Time is not infinite — sessions must be timboxed** Every prompt should take no more than 15 minutes. The system must be resumable from exactly where it left off — no re-orientation tax.

PM Dev · Artifact #6

Vision Statement

Vision Statement v1.1 You May 2026 Approved

THE HORIZON — CHANGED WORLD IF WE FULLY SUCCEED

> *"A world where the gap between a brilliant idea and a shipped product is no longer determined by how your mind works — where anyone who thinks in systems and leads with creativity has a process designed for the way they actually think."*

VISION BREAKDOWN

Audience Every creative, systems-minded person whose process needs to match the speed and style of their thinking

Changed world Execution is no longer determined by cognitive wiring — it is accessible to every kind of mind

Time horizon Long-term north star — the flag on the mountain that every product decision points toward

Scope Broader than PMD as a tool — positions the system as a movement toward cognitively-inclusive product development

PM DISTINCTION — VISION VS. MISSION VS. BRAND PROMISE

Document	Question it answers	Audience	Time horizon
Vision statement	What changed world are we building?	Internal team + long-term investors	5–10 years
Mission statement	What do we do and for whom?	External stakeholders	Ongoing
Brand promise	Why should a user care right now?	Direct user / candidate	Immediate

VERSION HISTORY

Version	Key Change	Date
v1.0	Initial approved vision statement — neurological wiring framing	April 2026
v1.1	Revised for above-fold use — removed implicit neurological self-disclosure. Meaning preserved: barrier is cognitive style, not ca	May 2026

PM Dev · Artifact #7

Brand Promise

Brand Promise	v3.0	You	April 2026	Approved

BRAND PROMISE STATEMENT

You think in explosions — magnificent, cascading — and you can already see the solution: every feature, every user, every edge case.

You have the vision.

What you need is a system fast enough to keep up with you, to capture it all, yet robust enough to turn that vision into reality and rigorous enough to show you exactly what to do next.

PM Dev is that system. It holds the complexity so you maintain focus. It closes the gap between the idea in your head and a shipped product in the world — comprehensively, professionally, at your speed. Nothing missed. Nothing left behind.

Sounds too good to be true?

Trust yourself. The portfolio you build will prove it.

SUPPORTING PROMISE BREAKDOWN

EMOTIONAL PROMISE

- Anxiety relief through comprehensive coverage
- PM Dev is so comprehensive you never have to wonder what you've missed
- The system holds the map — you maintain focus
- Every phase, every artifact, every decision point is accounted for

FUNCTIONAL PROMISE

- Best-practice speed and professional-grade output
- Follows the same structured process used by the best product teams in the world
- Every step produces a real, versioned, professional artifact
- The output isn't just done — it's done at the standard that gets people hired

VERSION HISTORY

Version	Key Change
v1.0	Initial draft — three options generated by coach
v2.0	User hybrid draft — Jarvis/Stark framing introduced, 'you were never missing the vision' added
v3.0	Final approved — 'magnificent, cascading' restored, 'maps' replaced with 'closes', structure tightened

PM Dev · Artifact #8 · 90-day cycle · Q2 2026

Objectives & Key Results (OKRs)

OKRs	v2.1	You	April 2026	Approved

PROJECT MAP — SCOPE DEFINED

Project 0	Project 1	Project 2	Project n
Portfolio shell PM Dev system built alongside	Word game First true PM Dev test. Showcased in P0.	TBD Begins within 7 days of P1 finish	Ongoing Living system compounds.

O1 — PERSONAL GROWTH · P0: ≤10 DAYS · P1: ≤90 DAYS

Prove to myself that I can execute a complete software product from idea to deployment — and feel it.

O1·KR1	**Project 0 portfolio shell is live at a public URL within 10 days using Claude Code. Project 1 word game is shipped and showcased within the portfolio site within 90 days.** Deployed, accessible, shareable. Not 'mostly done.' Live.
O1·KR2	**All 9 PM Dev phases completed with documented artifacts for both Project 0 and Project 1.** Every phase produces at least one versioned artifact stored in the PM Dev playbook. No phases skipped.
O1·KR3	**Self-reported confidence score reaches 5/10 by end of Project 1.** After P0: 2–3. After P1: 4–5. After P2: 5–6. After P3: 7. Scored honestly, not aspirationally.

O2 — PRODUCT · 90-DAY CYCLE

Ship a portfolio that makes a hiring evaluator say 'this candidate demonstrates executive-level insights' — not just execution, but business acumen, analytical depth, and professional range.

O2·KR1	**Project 1 fully showcased: interface, problem statement, PM artifacts, and business/analytical artifacts visible in the portfolio.** Goes beyond core PM documents. Includes data analysis, business case framing, and domain insights.
O2·KR2	**3 companies invite me for associate or junior PM interviews within 90 days of portfolio launch.** Real market validation. If the portfolio earns interviews, the objective is met.
O2·KR3	**Project n site traffic and usage metrics are captured, analyzed, and visualized as a living artifact within the portfolio.** Demonstrates post-deployment monitoring, analytics interpretation, and data visualization skills.

O3 — SYSTEM · LIVING — NO EXPIRY

Establish PM Dev as both a repeatable and living system — one that improves with every project and gets faster, sharper, and more valuable over time.

O3·KR1	**PM Dev Playbook exists, is current, and fully documents Project 0.** A living Google Doc. Any future session can resume in under 5 minutes using it as the only reference.
O3·KR2	**Project n begins within 7 days of finishing Project n-1.** The momentum window is real — this KR enforces it.
O3·KR3	**Zero phases skipped on Project n.** Rigor is non-negotiable.
O3·KR4	**A retrospective is documented after every project and improvement recommendations are incorporated into PM Dev before Project n+1 begins.** No project ends without a retro. No new project begins without implementing previous lessons.

PM Dev · Artifact #9

Competitive Analysis

Competitive Analysis	v1.0	You	April 2026	Approved

THE FOUR COPING BEHAVIOR CATEGORIES — WHAT PEOPLE DO WITHOUT PM DEV

1 — CONSUME

Passive learning at high volume · *Medium · Substack · YouTube · Podcasts*

WHAT IT DOES WELL

- Broad vocabulary and terminology exposure
- Access to world-class thinkers cheaply
- Maintains motivation and connection to the field

CRITICAL GAP

- Zero output — nothing shipped, nothing built
- Knowledge without application context fades fast
- Fuels the learning dopamine loop without progress

2 — CONNECT

Community and social proof · *LinkedIn · Meetup · Slack communities*

WHAT IT DOES WELL

- Reduces isolation and imposter feelings temporarily
- Networking surface for job opportunities
- Peer learning and shared experience

CRITICAL GAP

- Belonging without output is still zero portfolio
- Requires existing network to gain value quickly
- High noise, low signal for solo learners

3 — CREDENTIAL

Structured learning with a badge · *Udemy · Coursera · Product School · Bootcamps*

WHAT IT DOES WELL

- Structured curriculum reduces unknown unknowns
- Certificate adds resume credibility signal
- Mock projects provide artifact templates

CRITICAL GAP

- Mock projects aren't real — no deployed product
- Generic curriculum ignores individual cognitive wiring
- Expensive, time-consuming, often incomplete

4 — PRACTICE

Performance rehearsal · *PM Exercises · Exponent · Interview prep*

WHAT IT DOES WELL

- Builds interview fluency and confidence
- Exposes common PM frameworks quickly
- Low time investment per session

CRITICAL GAP

- Rehearsal for a stage that doesn't exist yet
- Produces polished answers, not real experience
- No portfolio artifact produced

THE STRATEGIC GAP — PM DEV'S WHITE SPACE

Every competitor prepares you to talk about being a PM. None of them make you one.

Across all four coping behavior categories, the aspirational PM accumulates vocabulary, community, certificates, and interview fluency. What they never accumulate is a shipped product. PM Dev occupies the only position in this landscape that produces a real, deployed, publicly accessible artifact as its primary output.

Secondary gap: no existing resource is designed for the ADHD-wired creative professional.

Every competitor assumes linear, sustained attention. None are designed around burst ideation, activation paralysis, or the vision-to-execution gap. PM Dev is the only system in this space built for the way this user actually thinks.

CAPABILITY MATRIX

Capability	Consume	Connect	Credential	Practice	PM Dev
Produces shipped product	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Real PM artifacts	✗	✗	Mock	Mock	✓
ADHD-adapted process	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
AI co-pilot built in	✗	✗	Some	✗	✓
Progressive disclosure	✗	✗	Partial	✗	✓
Portfolio as output	✗	✗	Mock	✗	✓
Free / low cost	✓	✓	✗	Partial	✓
Learns from your projects	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓

PM Dev · Artifact #10 · Mid-point Review

Retrospective — Phases 1 through 3

Retrospective	v1.0	You	April 2026	Approved

WHAT WORKED WELL	WHAT TO IMPROVE	QUESTIONS STILL OPEN
• Socratic prompting kept engagement without overwhelm • Self-disclosure produced richer research than any formal interview • Visible artifacts after each session created momentum proof • Panic word 'too much' established as a safety valve • Brand promise iteration ran a full professional creative cycle • OKR stress-test produced genuinely honest metrics	• User approves artifacts more than drafts them — shift balance in P5+ • Some answers accepted as broad when precision was needed • Feedback weighted toward encouragement — recalibrate gradually • PM Dev Playbook Google Doc not yet created — needed before Phase 5 • Context window usage growing — session summary doc needed soon	• What does the portfolio site actually look like visually? • What tech stack serves Project 0 best for a solo builder? • How does PM Dev get saved and resumed across sessions? • When does the user draft vs. approve artifacts? • What is the word game's core mechanic exactly?

FEEDBACK CALIBRATION SCALE — PROJECT BY PROJECT

P0 · Portfolio shell	Supportive scaffolding — I generate, you approve, I explain why	**15%**
P1 · Word game	Guided drafting — you draft first on key artifacts, I critique	**35%**
P2 · TBD	Critical collaboration — I challenge assumptions	**55%**
P3 · TBD	CPO peer review mode — I respond as a CPO reviewing PM work	**75%**
P4+ · TBD	Professional friction — open disagreement, you defend decisions	**95%**

SYSTEM IMPROVEMENTS INCORPORATED BEFORE PHASE 4

→ **Draft-first protocol begins at Phase 5 PRD**
User drafts key artifacts in rough form before coach generates polished version. Builds real synthesis skill.

→ **Precision pushback activated**
Coach will return vague answers with a sharper follow-up question rather than synthesizing breadth into specificity.

→ **PM Dev Playbook Google Doc — action item before Phase 5**
User creates a Google Doc titled 'PM Dev Playbook — Living Document' and pastes all approved artifacts.

→ **Context window management**
A session summary will be generated at the end of each major phase to enable clean handoff to a new conversation.

→ **Honest compliments remain — but now paired with a specific improvement note**
Encouragement is real and stays. Every compliment now comes with one concrete thing to do better next time.

Now / Next / Later Roadmap

Project 0 — Portfolio Shell | v1.0 | April 2026 | Approved

NOW	NEXT	LATER
01 **Re-entry ignition** Commitment live. P0 is the active project. The catalyst has fired.	01 **Full-stack PM identity lands in 5 seconds** Business fluency + technical fluency. Visitor knows immediately.	01 **PMD proves itself** Multiple shipped projects demonstrate the system adapts, grows, and scales with the user.
02 **Project 0 live at a public URL** Deployed, accessible, shareable. Not mostly done. Live.	02 **Marketing layer** Anticipates Hiring Evaluator's checklist. CTAs lure to proof.	02 **Project backlog prioritization framework** Goldilocks sequencing — each project stretches capability without triggering the stall.
03 **PMD Playbook repository exists** All approved artifacts stored, versioned, and accessible. Single source of truth.	03 **Proof layer architecture** Mock content in P0. Real deliverables swapped in from P1 forward.	
	04 **Conversion layer** One-click contact, targeted sharing, curated links. Frictionless path to outreach.	

Product Requirements Document

Project 0 — Portfolio Shell

APPROVED · May 2026 · v1.2

---

1 · PROBLEM STATEMENT

The Visionary Staller (Persona #1) is concurrently learning software product management and generating proof of that learning through personal projects — but has no medium to display or share that work. Without a portfolio, the learning stays invisible and the employment goal stays out of reach.

The Hiring Evaluator (Persona #2) needs to assess candidate fit within seconds of page load. They will not wait for context to accumulate — competency must be legible immediately, with compelling enough evidence to warrant a deeper look.

Project 0 — the Portfolio Shell — exists to solve both problems simultaneously: it gives Persona #1 a live, public showcase for their PMD work product and mindset, and it gives Persona #2 the fast, credible signal they need to decide a candidate is worth a conversation.

2 · GOALS & SUCCESS METRICS

Project 0 succeeds when a hiring evaluator can land on a live, public URL, understand what PMD builds and how they think, see real PMD artifacts as evidence of process, and have one frictionless path to make contact — all without a single broken link, missing image, or 'coming soon' placeholder.

Metric	Definition	Target
Deployed	Live at public URL, accessible without login	Binary — yes or no
Artifact visibility	PMD artifacts (PRD, Roadmap) visible and readable on-site	Binary — yes or no
Vision copy	Above-fold copy communicates site vision and process in 2 sentences or fewer per concept	Binary — yes or no
Contact path	Email address visible and correctly formatted	Binary — yes or no
Monthly visitors	Raw count via any analytics tool	Baseline established at launch

Out of Scope — P0: Style guide, GitHub environments, A/B testing, event tracking beyond visitor count, responsive optimization, CTA click-through rate, conversion tracking, contact form, broken links check.

3 · USER STORIES

Persona #2 — The Hiring Evaluator

- As a hiring evaluator, I want to see artifact examples so that I know the candidate is capable of producing the role's requisite scope of work.
- As a hiring evaluator, I want to quickly learn what the candidate's projects are and why they chose these specific examples so I can better understand their product mindset.
- As a hiring evaluator, I want to contact the candidate so that I can set up an interview.

Persona #1 — The Product Manager

• As a product manager, I want to send a single URL to a hiring evaluator so that they can immediately access my portfolio without any login or download required.
• As a product manager, I want to utilize CI/CD so I can make local content changes and seamlessly deploy updates to the live site without taking it offline.
• As a product manager, I want to integrate Google Analytics so that I can quantify site visitors and establish a baseline traffic metric.

Out of Scope — P0: Artifact detail drill-down, success metric visualizations, A/B testing, CMS, SEO tracking, scalable architecture patterns.

4 · FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

ID	Requirement	Persona
FR-01	Custom Domain — The site shall be accessible via a clean, personal top-level domain without platform subdomains. A valid URL shall return the live site with no 404 errors.	P1
FR-02	Static Render — When the URL loads, all page content shall render completely without requiring any additional user action, login, or download. The site shall be responsive across mobile, tablet, and desktop.	P1
FR-03	CI/CD Deployment — When the product manager commits changes locally, an integrated CI/CD workflow shall deploy those changes to the live site without uptime interruption.	P1
FR-04	Analytics — The site shall include a Google Analytics snippet that captures and reports visitor traffic to the product manager's dashboard.	P1
FR-05	Above-Fold Artifact Thumbnails — The site shall render thumbnail images of PMD artifacts above the fold, each paired with a brief text label identifying the artifact type.	P2
FR-06	Above-Fold Vision Copy — The site shall render concise copy above the fold communicating the site's product purpose, vision, and reason for creation in two sentences or fewer per concept.	P2
FR-07	Below-Fold Artifact Detail — The site shall render a larger image and descriptive copy for each artifact below the fold, reachable by scrolling, providing sufficient detail for a hiring evaluator to assess PM thinking without navigating away.	P2
FR-08	Contact Path — The site shall display the owner's email address in plain visible text, requiring no interaction to reveal. Do not wrap in an anchor mailto tag.	P2
FR-09	Accessibility — The site shall conform to WCAG 2.2 Level AA at minimum across all page zones. Requirements include: semantic HTML landmark structure, color contrast ratios of 4.5:1 for normal text and 3:1 for large text, full keyboard navigability, visible focus indicators, meaningful alt text on all images and icons, ARIA labels on all named regions, iframe title attributes, and no reliance on color alone to convey information. This requirement is non-negotiable and applies to all current and future PMD projects.	P1 + P2

FR-09 added v1.2 — WCAG 2.2 Level AA — non-negotiable across all PMD projects.

Out of Scope — P0: Clickable artifact links, modal overlays, contact form, artifact filtering, navigation menu, external links.

5 · TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

Stack

Layer	Decision	Rationale
Build tool	Claude Code	AI-assisted development. Primary execution tool for P0.

Frontend	HTML / CSS / Vanilla JS	No framework overhead. Static page, zero dependencies.
Version control	GitHub	Industry standard. Free. CI/CD integration native.
Hosting	Netlify	Free tier. Custom domain support. CI/CD on push. Simpler DNS config than GitHub Pages.
Domain	ThePMDev.com	Already owned. Connect to Netlify via DNS configuration.
Analytics	Google Analytics (GA4)	Free. Industry standard. Single snippet, no backend required.
Design tooling	None at P0	See Strategy B decision below.
PM tooling	None at P0	See Strategy B decision below.

Tooling — Strategy B Decision · Documented Tradeoff · April 2026

Professional PM tooling — Figma, Notion, Jira, Confluence — was evaluated and deliberately deferred for P0. The tension: full tool adoption before building maximizes professional skill signal but introduces learning curve costs that threaten the 10-day OKR. Every hour configuring Jira sprints is an hour not shipping.

The decision: Ship P0 first using Claude Code and GitHub as the only required tools. Introduce professional tooling progressively from P1 forward, where each tool is adopted in service of a real workflow need rather than as a setup exercise.

The PM rationale: Strategy B produces a stronger hiring signal than Strategy A — because it demonstrates the ability to ship under constraint, make deliberate tradeoff decisions, and sequence complexity appropriately. The tools will be demonstrated. They will not be prerequisites.

Deferred to P1+: Figma (wireframing), Notion (PRD documentation), Jira (sprint planning and story points), Confluence (asset and documentation management).

CI/CD Workflow

Local development → GitHub commit → Netlify auto-deploy → ThePMDev.com live with zero downtime.

Constraints

- Static site only — no backend, no database, no server-side logic at P0.
- All content hardcoded — no CMS.
- Responsive across mobile, tablet, and desktop — built in from day one.
- Total build time target: 10 days from PRD approval.
- WCAG 2.2 Level AA conformance — non-negotiable — see FR-09.

VERSION HISTORY

Version	Key Change	Date
v1.0	Initial PRD — full requirements defined across 5 sections	April 2026
v1.1	Minor copy refinements — out of scope clarifications added	April 2026
v1.2	FR-09 added — WCAG 2.2 Level AA accessibility requirement. Non-negotiable across all PMD projects. Constraint bullet added to Section 5.	May 2026

Green row = updated this session

PMD · Project 0 · Portfolio Shell

Artifact #13 · Wireframe v4 · Phase 6 · Approved · May 2026

Phase 6 Complete — Build Spec Ready for Claude Code

PHASE 6 SUMMARY

Phase 6 — Design & Wireframing is complete. Four wireframe iterations produced (v1 above-fold structure → v2 full page → v3 color + copy → v4 final approved). All design decisions locked. All assets confirmed. Build spec ready for Phase 7.

DESIGN SYSTEM — LOCKED

Color Palette

Token	Hex	Usage
--color-black	#111111	Above fold · below fold · appendix · footer — all backgrounds
--color-white	#FFFFFF	Body text on black · artifact tile bg · Playbook PDF pages
--color-off-white	#FAFAFA	Artifact tile background (slight warmth)
--color-gray-dark	#444444	Top-right nav placeholder · deferred legal links
--color-gray-mid	#888888	Artifact metadata labels · footer nav items

Typography

Role	Font	Weight	Size	Usage
Display	Syne	700	2.5–3rem	H1 'The PMD System' · section headings
Body	Plus Jakarta Sans	400	1rem	All body copy · blockquote · artifact copy
Label	Plus Jakarta Sans	600	.875rem	Artifact question headings · nav items
Meta	Plus Jakarta Sans	400	.8rem	Version labels · footer legal text

Color Rhythm — Scroll Sequence

Zone	Background	Text	Visual Moment
Above fold	#111111	#FFFFFF	Black canvas · white copy · charcoal sketch thumbnails
Icon row	#111111	Branded	First color burst — 7 full-color branded SVG icons
Below fold	#111111	#FFFFFF	Black canvas · white artifact tiles pop as contrast
Appendix	#111111	#FFFFFF	Black surround · white Playbook pages inside iframe
Footer	#111111	#FFF / #888	Black · white primary · gray secondary text

PAGE ZONES — IMPLEMENTATION SPEC

Zone 1 — Above Fold (FR-05 · FR-06)

Element	Implementation Detail
Top-right nav	Home · Work · Process · Contact — color #444 — plain <span> no href at P0
Logo	<img src='assets/pmd-logo.png'> — border-radius: 50% — top left — ~56px diameter
H1	Syne 700 — centered — white — 2.5rem desktop / 1.75rem mobile — 'The PMD System'
Blockquote	Left border 2px #444 — italic Plus Jakarta Sans — Vision Statement copy (Artifact #6)
PRD sketch	assets/PRD_sketch.png — right of blockquote — object-fit:cover — height = blockquote +18px overrun
Roadmap sketch	assets/pmd_roadmap_sketch.png — below logo — top = blockquote bottom +12px — slight bottom overrun
Scroll cue	Animated chevron ↓ — CSS keyframe fade/bounce — color #555 — centered

Thumbnail offset rule: neither image is grid-locked to text. PRD overruns blockquote ±18px. Roadmap top = blockquote bottom + 12px. Intentional visual tension.

Zone 2 — Icon Row · Fold Divider (Direction A Credibility Signal)

Icon	Brand Color	Source
Git	#F05133	git-scm.com/downloads/logos
GitHub	#24292E on dark bg	simpleicons.org
Claude	#CC785C	anthropic.com/brand
HTML5	#E44D26	simpleicons.org
CSS3	#264DE4	simpleicons.org
JavaScript	#F7DF1E (black text)	simpleicons.org
Netlify	#00AD9F	netlify.com/press

Icon row: 32px height · auto width · flex row · gap 1.5rem · black bg · full bleed width.

Zone 3 — Below Fold · Curated Artifacts (FR-07)

#	Question Copy	Artifact	Asset File
1	"Can you define scope and ship to requirements?"	Artifact #12 · PRD · v1.1	artifact-prd.pdf
2	"Do you sequence work and think in systems?"	Artifact #11 · Roadmap · v1.0	artifact-roadmap.pdf
3	"Do you actually understand your users?"	Artifact #2 · Persona #1 · v1.0	artifact-persona.pdf
4	"Can you frame a real problem worth solving?"	Artifact #1 · Problem Statement · v1.0	artifact-problem-statement.pdf

Section heading: 'The work' — Syne — white on black — centered. Each tile: white bg · black text · PDF preview left · question heading + metadata right.

Zone 4 — Appendix · Full Playbook

Element	Implementation
Container	Black bg · dashed white border 1px · border-radius 6px · padding 2rem
Label	'PMD Playbook — Living Document' · Syne · white · centered
CTA text	'See the complete PMD process →' · Plus Jakarta Sans · #888
Viewer	<iframe src='assets/PMD_Playbook.pdf' width='100%' height='600px'> — white PDF pages inside black

Zone 5 — Footer (FR-08)

Element	Position	Implementation
PMD logo	Left	assets/pmd-logo.png · ~44px · circular
TOS · Privacy	Below logo · left	Plain text · color #444 · no href at P0 · '(coming soon)'
Stacked nav	Right column	Home · Work · Process · Contact · vertical · color #888 · no href P0
Email	Below nav divider · right	hello@thepmdev.com · white · plain text — NO mailto link · FR-08

FR-08: email must be plain visible text — no form, no link, no friction. Do not wrap in an anchor mailto tag.

ASSET INVENTORY — /ASSETS/ DIRECTORY

File	Type	Source	Status
pmd-logo.png	PNG	Provided by PM Dev	Ready
PRD_sketch.png	PNG charcoal sketch	Provided by PM Dev	Ready
pmd_roadmap_sketch.png	PNG charcoal sketch	Provided by PM Dev	Ready
git.svg	SVG brand icon	git-scm.com/downloads/logos	Download
github.svg	SVG brand icon	simpleicons.org	Download
claude.svg	SVG brand icon	anthropic.com/brand	Download
html5.svg	SVG brand icon	simpleicons.org	Download
css3.svg	SVG brand icon	simpleicons.org	Download
javascript.svg	SVG brand icon	simpleicons.org	Download
netlify.svg	SVG brand icon	netlify.com/press	Download
artifact-prd.pdf	PDF	PMD Playbook — Artifact #12	Export from Playbook
artifact-roadmap.pdf	PDF	PMD Playbook — Artifact #11	Export from Playbook
artifact-persona.pdf	PDF	PMD Playbook — Artifact #2	Export from Playbook
artifact-problem-statement.pdf	PDF	PMD Playbook — Artifact #1	Export from Playbook
PMD_Playbook_Living_Document.pdf	PDF	Full Playbook export	Export from Google Doc

PRD REQUIREMENTS CHECKLIST — FR-01 THROUGH FR-08

ID	Requirement	Implementation
FR-01	Custom domain — no platform subdomain	ThePMDev.com via Netlify DNS configuration
FR-02	Static render — no login — responsive	HTML/CSS/JS · no backend · responsive breakpoints built in
FR-03	CI/CD — commit → auto-deploy → zero downtime	GitHub → Netlify auto-deploy pipeline
FR-04	Google Analytics GA4 snippet	Single <script> in <head> · GA4 measurement ID
FR-05	Above-fold thumbnails + brief labels	PRD sketch + Roadmap sketch · portrait crop · offset placement
FR-06	Above-fold vision copy ≤2 sentences each	H1 + blockquote (Vision #6) + Brand Promise excerpt (#7)
FR-07	Below-fold artifact detail — scroll reachable	4 artifact tiles · question copy · PDF preview · metadata
FR-08	Email address — plain text — no interaction	hello@thepmdev.com · footer right · plain text · no mailto

WIREFRAME VERSION HISTORY

Version	Key Change	Status
v1	Above-fold structure — hero copy block + thumbnails + icon row divider	Superseded
v2	Full page added — below fold artifact blocks + appendix + footer	Superseded
v3	Color zones applied — black below fold + evaluator question copy + footer restructure	Superseded
v4	Thumbnail offset from grid · full black treatment · footer stacked nav · top-right nav added	APPROVED

Retrospective — Phases 4 through 7

What worked well

Introductory depth was the right call — phases 4–7 were scoped to avoid overwhelm and prevent process stagnation, not because of a lack of ambition.

Iterative design in Phases 6 & 7 matched the user's cognitive style — trying something, reflecting, and adjusting produced a stronger result than locking decisions up front.

Bite-sized prompts kept sessions moving. No single task triggered shutdown.

A live URL shipped. That is the primary success metric. It is met.

User correctly distinguished between personal aesthetic preference and evaluator need — a genuine PM thinking pattern.

What to improve

Late-night sessions (ending 4–6am) degraded retention. Process knowledge blurred across the irregular session gaps. Pacing is a system constraint, not a willpower problem.

User stories and acceptance criteria felt administrative rather than functional — they weren't visible during design decisions, so their value wasn't felt in real time.

Documentation and version tracking remain a friction point. The tedium is real. Mitigation: tighter artifact templates and shorter update loops at P1.

Coaching feedback still weighted toward encouragement. Calibration increases begin at P1 as planned.

Questions still open

Is the current site design flexible enough to absorb future projects? Decision deferred correctly — stress-test with real P1 artifacts before changing anything.

What is P1's project? Word game deprioritised — feature scope too large for a second project. Alternatives to be evaluated at P1 kickoff against one criterion: stretches capability without triggering the stall.

How does PM process vocabulary and phase structure get retained? Answer: repetition through execution, not pre-study. The second pass through the phases will feel familiar.

Confidence score — honest calibration

Baseline (start of P0)	**0.5 / 10**	No system. No artifacts. No deployed product.
Post-P0 (current)	**1.0 / 10**	Live URL shipped. 13 artifacts approved. Process completed once. Retention is low but the path is proven.
Target — post-P1	**4–5 / 10**	Second full pass through all 9 phases. First draft responsibility increases. Coaching friction increases. Process starts to feel owned, not borrowed.
What moves the score	—	Executing P1 completely. Retention comes from repetition, not pre-study. Flashcards won't close the gap. Another shipped project will.

Feedback calibration scale — project by project

P0 · Portfolio		Supportive scaffolding — coach generates, user approves

P1 · Word game / TBD		Guided drafting — user drafts first, coach critiques
P2 · TBD		Critical collaboration — assumptions challenged
P3 · TBD		CPO peer review mode — respond as a CPO reviewing PM work
P4+ · TBD		Professional friction — open disagreement, user defends decisions

---

System improvements incorporated before P1

- **Session length — enforce the 10-minute entry point**
  The 4–5 hour window belief is the stall mechanism, not a real prerequisite. P1 sessions open with one prompt and one answer. That is a complete session. The runway does not need to be long to justify starting.
- **Draft-first protocol — fully active at P1**
  User drafts key artifacts in rough form before coach generates polished version. Acceptance criteria and user stories drafted by user first — so they are felt as functional tools, not administrative overhead.
- **Pushback calibration — increase at P1**
  Coaching feedback shifts from encouragement-led to precision-led. Vague answers returned with a sharper follow-up question. Assumptions named and challenged. Encouragement stays — it is now paired with a specific improvement note every time.
- **P1 project selection — deliberate scoping**
  Word game deprioritised. Feature scope (auth, payments, multiplayer, admin) is too large for project two. P1 project selected at kickoff against one criterion: stretches capability without triggering the stall. Alternatives welcomed.
- **Documentation rhythm — shorter loops**
  Documentation aversion is real and will not disappear. Mitigation: tighter artifact templates, version updates happen at session close while context is live — not deferred to a separate session.

Artifact depth assessment — Phases 4–7

Phase	Artifact	Depth at P0	What expands at P1+
4 — Roadmap	Now / Next / Later	Introductory. Three horizons, clean sequencing, deliberate first decision.	Prioritisation frameworks (RICE, MoSCoW). Dependency mapping. Confidence scores per initiative.
5 — PRD	Product Requirements Document	Solid foundation. Eight FRs, five technical decisions, one documented tradeoff. User stories present but felt administrative.	Acceptance criteria drafted by user first. Stories tied visibly to design decisions. Edge cases documented.

6 — Design	Wireframe v4	Four iterations. Locked design system. Full zone-by-zone implementation spec. Strong signal for a first wireframing pass.	Figma introduced at P1. Component states. Interaction annotations. Handoff-ready specs.
7 — Build	Deployed site — all five zones	HTML / CSS / Vanilla JS. Five zones. Responsive CSS. Live at thepmdev.com. FR-09 WCAG 2.2 AA met.	Component-level thinking. JavaScript interactions. CI/CD discipline. Analytics live.

Launch & Marketing Plan — Project 0

Show, don't tell. The hiring evaluator should see irresistible project thumbnails — each solving a materially different business problem — and feel compelled to click. 80%+ of visitors should find at least one project that directionally maps to a problem their company needs solved.

Launch trigger & timeline

Condition	Definition	Status
Soft launch — now	Site is live. URL shared selectively with known contacts and included in targeted applications. No broad distribution. Audience is warm contacts and specific bootcamp/cohort contexts only.	**Active**
Full launch trigger	P0 UI/UX iteration complete AND minimum three portfolio-worthy projects showcased. Each project solves a materially different, evaluator-relevant business problem.	Pending
Full launch deadline	180 days from today — hard constraint. Stretch target 100 days. Probable target 150 days. This deadline is non-negotiable.	180-day clock running
LinkedIn activation	URL added to LinkedIn profile when full launch trigger is met — not before. Premature LinkedIn distribution exposes an incomplete product to the highest-value channel.	Deferred

---

Audience map — who, channel, timing

Audience	Channel	Timing	Note
Known PM contact	Zoom — URL in chat	Completed — soft launch	Wrong benchmark. Evaluating code depth, not PM artifacts. Signal: not the right demo audience yet.
Backend dev — meetup	In-person — live URL	Completed — soft launch	Wrong audience. Frontend-only portfolio at a backend dev showcase. No signal value. No action required.
Product bootcamp / cohort	Application — URL included	Completed — accepted	Signal is in the work produced inside the cohort, not the acceptance. All applicants accepted.
X.com (pinned profile)	Public profile link	Active now — UTM needed	UTM parameter required before Phase 9 measurement begins. See UTM section below.
LinkedIn	Profile URL field	Deferred — full launch trigger	Highest-value channel. Only activated when product is showcase-ready with 3+ portfolio projects.

Associate PM job applications	Application — URL field	Deferred — full launch trigger	Primary conversion channel. Activated at full launch trigger only. Every application before that trigger is a rehearsal.
Hiring evaluators — direct	Email / referral	Deferred — full launch trigger	Target audience. Not yet reached directly. This is the audience the entire product is built for.

UTM parameter structure — Phase 9 measurement enablement

UTM parameters are appended to the portfolio URL so GA4 can attribute each visit to its source. Without UTMs, all traffic appears as Direct in GA4 and channel performance is invisible. Two UTMs are required before Phase 9 begins.

Channel	UTM Source	UTM Medium	UTM Campaign	Full URL pattern
X.com pinned profile	twitter	social	p0-soft-launch	thepmdev.com/?utm_source=twitter&utm;_medium=social&utm;_campaign=p0-soft-launch
LinkedIn profile	linkedin	social	p0-full-launch	thepmdev.com/?utm_source=linkedin&utm;_medium=social&utm;_campaign=p0-full-launch
Job applications	job-app	referral	p0-applications	thepmdev.com/?utm_source=job-app&utm;_medium=referral&utm;_campaign=p0-applications
Direct / email	direct-outreach	email	p0-outreach	thepmdev.com/?utm_source=direct-outreach&utm;_medium=email&utm;_campaign=p0-outreach

Action required before Phase 9: Replace the X.com pinned URL with the UTM-tagged version. LinkedIn and job application UTMs activated at full launch trigger.

P0 v2 — homepage vision (locked for UI/UX iteration phase)

The following direction was defined during Phase 8 and is locked as the creative brief for the P0 UI/UX iteration. It does not get built now. It gets built after the full launch trigger conditions are understood and at least one portfolio project exists to populate it.

Show, don't tell — homepage vision	**What the homepage will not be**
Multiple irresistible project thumbnail teasers — each showcasing a solution to a materially different business problem relevant to hiring evaluators. Each thumbnail communicates the problem solved: drive revenue, reduce churn, improve efficiencies, reduce costs, increase engagement. The evaluator self-selects the one that maps to their company's current need. 80%+ of visitors find at least one project that directionally resonates. This is the primary UX success metric for the homepage. Clicking a thumbnail is the primary conversion action. Everything else on the page exists to make that click feel inevitable.	No 'About Me' word wall. No predictable work history recitation. No FAANG name-dropping. No passion statements. No years-of-experience counters. Nobody has time to read it. Nobody will. The evaluator has 30 seconds. Every word that isn't a project thumbnail is a word that competes with the thing that actually converts. This is a product portfolio, not a resume rendered as a webpage. The work speaks. The page gets out of the way.

Project classification — learning projects vs. portfolio projects

Not every project ships to the portfolio. This distinction was surfaced during Phase 8 and is a foundational sequencing decision for all future projects.

Type	Definition	Goes to portfolio?	Example
Learning project	Exists to build a specific technical or PM capability. The output is skill, not showcase. Completed to the same PMD process standard but not featured on thepmdev.com.	No — internal only	A CRUD app built to learn database fundamentals. Valuable. Not evaluator-relevant.
Portfolio project	Solves a real, specific, evaluator-relevant problem. Demonstrates PM thinking, technical execution, and business acumen simultaneously. Featured on thepmdev.com.	**Yes — full showcase**	A churn prediction dashboard built for a SaaS context. Solves a named problem hiring managers recognise immediately.
Classification trigger	The question is: would a hiring evaluator see this project thumbnail and feel the problem it solves is relevant to their company? If yes — portfolio. If no — learning.	Decided at P1 kickoff per project	Classification happens at roadmap phase, not after build. Prevents building the wrong thing at the wrong depth.

Open items — Phase 8 actions

Item	Action required	When

X.com UTM	Replace pinned URL with UTM-tagged version: thepmdev.com/?utm_source=twitter&utm;_medium=social&utm;_campaign=p0-soft-launch	Before Phase 9 begins
Footer email placeholder	Replace hello@thepmdev.com with live purpose-built contact address before sharing site with evaluators.	Before full launch
GA4 measurement ID	Replace GA_MEASUREMENT_ID placeholder in index.html with live GA4 property ID.	Before Phase 9 begins
LinkedIn activation	Add UTM-tagged URL to LinkedIn profile. Activate only at full launch trigger — minimum three portfolio projects live.	Full launch trigger
P0 v2 UI/UX brief	Homepage vision locked in this document. PRD amendment and wireframe pass to be scoped after P1 project classification is complete.	Post-P1 kickoff

Measure & Iterate Plan — Project 0

Phase 9 closes the P0 loop. Instrumentation is live. This document defines what is being measured, what success and failure look like at each launch phase, what additional tooling is required, and what data will drive the P0 v2 iteration decisions.

Instrumentation stack

Tool	Purpose	Cost	Status	Action required
Google Analytics 4	Traffic volume, source attribution, session data, UTM channel tracking.	Free	**Live**	None. Measurement ID installed in index.html. Confirm data appearing in GA4 dashboard.
Netlify Analytics	Server-side hit logging including crawler traffic and vulnerability probes. Unaffected by ad blockers or GA4 script blocking.	Paid add-on	**Active**	Use as a cross-reference for GA4 data. Crawler and probe traffic visible here but filtered in GA4 — discrepancy between the two is normal.
Microsoft Clarity	Heatmaps, scroll depth tracking, cursor movement, click mapping, session recordings. Answers all five behavioural questions defined in Phase 9 brief.	Free — unlimited sessions	**Not yet installed**	Install before full launch. Single script tag in index.html head. GA4 integration available — connect both properties for combined reporting.
Bit.ly (X.com UTM)	Shortened UTM-tagged URL for X.com profile. Passes X.com URL validator. Redirects to full UTM string — GA4 receives parameters on arrival.	Free	**Active**	Monitor Bit.ly click count as a secondary check against GA4 twitter/social traffic. Counts should align directionally.

Success and failure definitions by launch phase

Soft launch — passing	Soft launch — failing
GA4 dashboard shows data — any data. Own test visits confirm the pipeline is working end to end. X.com Bit.ly link registers at least one click and GA4 shows a corresponding twitter/social session. UTM attribution confirmed working. Netlify and GA4 both show traffic. Discrepancy is expected — crawlers and probes appear in Netlify, not GA4. Directional alignment is the standard.	GA4 dashboard shows nothing — including own test visits. Pipeline broken. Check: Measurement ID correctly placed in both script src and gtag config call. X.com Bit.ly click registers in Bit.ly but does not appear in GA4 as twitter/social traffic. UTM string may be malformed — verify redirect destination. Netlify shows zero hits over multiple days. DNS or deployment issue — site may not be resolving correctly at thepmdev.com.

Full launch — passing	Full launch — needs iteration
Meaningful human traffic visible — sessions with scroll depth greater than 50%, time on site greater than 30 seconds. Distinguishable from crawlers by session behaviour. Channel attribution working across all active UTMs — twitter, linkedin, job-app, direct-outreach each appearing as distinct sources in GA4. Clarity heatmaps show scroll depth reaching Zone 3 artifact tiles for at least 40% of sessions. Evaluators are seeing the proof layer. At least one inbound contact — email or LinkedIn message — referencing the portfolio. Conversion signal, not just traffic.	Clarity shows majority of sessions ending in Zone 1 or Zone 2 — evaluators are not scrolling to the proof. Above-fold content is not compelling enough to earn the scroll. High bounce rate from LinkedIn channel relative to X.com — suggests LinkedIn audience has a higher bar and current content does not meet it. Zero inbound contact after 30 days of full launch traffic. Portfolio is being seen but not converting. Requires content or CTA audit. Rage clicks or repeated cursor movement on non-interactive elements — Clarity session recordings reveal UX confusion. Specific zones to be identified and addressed in P0 v2.

Behavioural metrics — Clarity instrumentation plan

The five behavioural questions below were defined during Phase 9 discovery. All five are answerable via Microsoft Clarity at zero cost. Clarity must be installed before full launch so data collection begins from day one of real traffic. Analysis happens after sufficient session volume — minimum 50 human sessions before drawing conclusions.

#	Question	Clarity feature	What it tells you
1	Are visitors scrolling at all?	Scroll depth heatmap	Confirms whether above-fold content earns the scroll. If the majority of sessions show less than 20% scroll depth, Zone 1 is not compelling enough.
2	Where do they stop scrolling?	Scroll depth heatmap — drop-off points	Identifies the exact zone where attention is lost. Zone 2 drop-off means thumbnails are not earning Zone 3. Zone 3 drop-off means tiles are not earning the appendix.

3	Do they resume after stopping?	Session recordings — individual playback	Distinguishes between a pause (content being read) and an exit (content abandoned). Pauses at Zone 3 tiles are a positive signal.
4	Where does the cursor move?	Move heatmap	Cursor movement proxies eye tracking. Clusters on specific artifact thumbnails or copy blocks indicate which content is drawing attention.
5	What do they click or attempt to click?	Click heatmap — dead clicks flagged automatically	Dead clicks on artifact thumbnails signal that evaluators expect them to be interactive. High dead click rate on thumbnails = P0 v2 priority: make them links.

Iterate triggers — what data drives what P0 v2 change

Signal observed	Interpretation	P0 v2 action
Majority of sessions end at Zone 1 or 2	Above-fold content not earning the scroll. Blockquote or H1 not resonating with evaluator's immediate needs.	Homepage redesign — project thumbnail grid above fold. Show don't tell vision activated earlier in the scroll.
High dead click rate on artifact thumbnails	Evaluators expect thumbnails to be interactive links — they are currently static images.	Make artifact thumbnails clickable. Link to individual project pages or expanded detail views.
Sessions reach Zone 3 but do not reach footer	Artifact tiles holding attention but no clear next action after reading. Contact path not being discovered.	Add a CTA after Zone 3 artifact tiles. Reduce distance between proof layer and contact path.
LinkedIn traffic bounces faster than X.com traffic	LinkedIn audience has higher bar. Current content does not meet the evaluator's immediate credibility threshold.	Prioritise above-fold credibility signals. Business acumen and PM process visible within 10 seconds of landing.
Zero inbound contact after 30 days of full launch	Portfolio seen but not converting. Evaluators are not compelled to reach out. Either content or contact friction is the blocker.	Audit contact path visibility. Audit whether project problems shown map to problems evaluators are actively trying to solve.

Open items — Phase 9 actions

Item	Action required	When	Priority
Microsoft Clarity installation	Create free Clarity account at clarity.microsoft.com. Copy tracking script. Add to index.html head section — same location as GA4 snippet. Connect Clarity property to GA4 property for combined reporting. Commit and push to trigger Netlify deploy.	Before full launch — as soon as possible	**High**

GA4 verification	Confirm GA4 Realtime report shows own test visit. Confirm X.com Bit.ly click appears as twitter / social / p0-soft-launch in GA4 Acquisition report.	Now — if not already done	**High**
Clarity baseline review	After minimum 50 human sessions post full launch — review scroll depth heatmap, click heatmap, and three session recordings. Document findings. Use iterate trigger table above to determine P0 v2 priorities.	Post full launch — 50 session threshold	Scheduled
Netlify UTM redirect	Optional upgrade — replace Bit.ly with a Netlify _redirects rule for thepmdev.com/twitter pointing to full UTM URL. Removes third-party dependency.	P0 v2 build phase	Low — deferred

---

PMD · Project Roadmap Architecture

Artifact #18 · v2.1 · May 2026 · 8 Phases · 66+ Projects · PMD System · Internal

ARCHITECTURE INTENT

What this document is	The master project sequencing architecture for the PMD development journey — v2.1, synthesized from multiple source frameworks. Eight progressive phases, 66+ scoped projects, a recommended reading curriculum, and offline practice assignments. The roadmap does not end at P66 — it extends as far as needed to reach portfolio milestone readiness.
What this document is not	A build guide. Projects are scoped by what they accomplish and what tools they use. How each project is built is determined project-by-project inside its own nine-phase PMD process cycle. No phase is skipped. No project closes without a retrospective.
Single evolving product strategy	From Phase III onward, projects build on a single evolving SaaS-style product codebase rather than disconnected apps. Each project adds one capability layer to the same product. By Phase VIII the cumulative product is a production-grade SaaS that becomes the flagship portfolio showcase.
User authentication placement	Authentication appears at three explicit points: P15 (Phase II) — managed auth via Supabase/Firebase, fastest path to a working login system; P19 (Phase III) — custom JWT auth from scratch, full ownership of every token, cookie, and reset flow; P25 (Phase IV) — org-level RBAC extending auth into team workspaces and invitation flows. Auth is not buried — it is an explicit named project at each level.
Portfolio milestone logic	Eight portfolio milestone candidates are marked throughout the roadmap with a star symbol (orange). No project is pre-designated as portfolio-worthy in advance. Portfolio status is earned by demonstrating PM depth, technical execution quality, and evaluator-relevant problem framing. The coach assesses readiness. The threshold emerges from the quality of the work — not from a date on a calendar.
Coaching calibration	Phases I–II: Guided Drafting — user drafts first, coach critiques. Phases III–IV: Critical Collaboration — assumptions challenged openly. Phases V–VI: CPO Peer Review — coach responds as a CPO reviewing PM work. Phases VII–VIII: Professional Friction — open disagreement, user defends every decision. Draft-first protocol is active from P1.

PORTFOLIO MILESTONE MAP

Project	Portfolio Type	Phase	Why It Works for Evaluators
P5	**Product Teardown & Redesign**	I	PM thinking fully visible before any backend code. Low technical dependency, high product instinct signal.
P33	**Cross-Functional GTM — Pricing Launch**	V	Pricing requires engineering, marketing, sales, and legal alignment. Full stakeholder coordination artifacts.
P36	**Metric Optimization — Activation**	V	Before/after activation metrics, funnel analysis, and A/B experiment design. Clearest PM impact story.
P43	**GTM — Integrations Platform Launch**	VI	Platform and ecosystem strategy. Integration catalog, OAuth2 flows, webhook reliability spec, GTM kit.

P50	**0-to-1 Greenfield — AI PRD Assistant**	VII	Solves a problem hiring managers experience personally. Full 0-to-1 cycle with AI, PRD, and launch plan.
P64	**Analytics PM — Executive Dashboard**	VIII	Business intelligence, cohort analysis, and KPI storytelling at executive reporting depth.
P65	**Cross-Functional GTM — Pricing Migration**	VIII	Enterprise GTM kit, stakeholder alignment artifacts, pricing migration risk log, and post-launch loop.
P66	**Flagship Capstone — Full SaaS Product**	VIII	Cumulative synthesis of all prior capabilities. Production SaaS with complete five-part case study suite.

USER AUTHENTICATION — WHERE IT LIVES IN THE ROADMAP

P15 · Phase II	MANAGED AUTH — Supabase or Firebase. Fastest path to a working login. Signup, login, logout, protected routes, email verification, password reset, and user-scoped data isolation. Recommended entry point: auth is live and functional before any custom backend work begins.
P19 · Phase III	CUSTOM JWT AUTH — Built from scratch. bcrypt password hashing, JWT access tokens, refresh token rotation, HTTP-only cookie storage, protected route middleware, and a full password reset flow via SendGrid email token. Full ownership — every security decision is explicit and documented.
P25 · Phase IV	ORG-LEVEL RBAC — Team and workspace layer. Workspace creation, email invitation with token validation, org-level roles (owner, admin, member), workspace switching, and member management UI. Extends P19 custom auth into a full organizational identity hierarchy.

PHASE OVERVIEW

Phase	Title	Range	Projects	Core Capabilities Introduced
I	**FOUNDATION**	P1 – P7	7	HTML · CSS · JS · Git · Figma · Netlify · Product communication and PRD habit from project one
II	**FRONT-END FRAMEWORK**	P8 – P16	9	React · TypeScript · Next.js · Headless CMS · Managed Auth (Supabase/Firebase) · Component architecture · Testing
III	**BACKEND & DATABASE**	P17 – P24	8	Node.js · Express · PostgreSQL · Prisma · Custom JWT Auth · File uploads · Transactional email · MongoDB
IV	**PRODUCT COLLABORATION & TEAM FEATURES**	P25 – P30	6	Multi-user workspaces · Team invitations · WebSockets (real-time) · Notifications · Feedback portal · Search
V	**PAYMENTS, MONETIZATION & GROWTH ANALYTICS**	P31 – P40	10	Stripe payments · Subscription billing · Feature flags · Behavioral analytics · A/B testing · Lifecycle email · SQL analytics · CDP
VI	**REAL-TIME, SCALE & ADVANCED INFRASTRUCTURE**	P41 – P47	7	BullMQ · Redis caching · OAuth2 integrations · GTM enablement · WCAG 2.2 AA audit · i18n/l10n · PWA
VII	**AI & MACHINE LEARNING INTEGRATION**	P48 – P56	9	OpenAI/Anthropic APIs · Vector databases · RAG pipelines · Document analysis · AI chatbots · ML model serving · Agentic workflows
VIII	**PLATFORM, MOBILE & PRODUCTION SCALE**	P57 – P66+	10	GraphQL · React Native mobile · Docker · CI/CD pipelines · Multi-tenant SaaS · Micro-frontends · Observability · SaaS capstone

Phase I · P1 – P7 FOUNDATION — Static Web, Git & Product Communication

Build the bedrock. Master HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Git, and deployment before touching any framework or library. Establish the product communication habit from day one: every project ships with a PRD, a problem statement, and at least one PM artifact. Introduce Figma for wireframing early so that design decisions precede build decisions on every project from here forward. The goal of this phase is not to build impressive products — it is to build the habit of shipping, documenting, and reflecting. Every project deploys to a live URL via the CI/CD pipeline established at P1. PM skills introduced: problem framing, persona writing, basic PRD drafting, case study structure, value proposition design, and the five-part portfolio narrative that governs every future showcase project.

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
	Personal Link-in-Bio / Profile Page				
P1	Single-page static site: profile section, curated links, social icons, and a goal statement. Fully responsive. First GitHub commit and Netlify deploy.	Problem framing · Single-user persona · Definition of done · First PRD	HTML5 semantic structure · CSS Flexbox · CSS custom properties · Git init and commit · Netlify CI/CD pipeline	HTML5 · CSS3 · Git · GitHub · Netlify	PRD v1 · Persona · Deployed URL
	■ *First ship. Prove the CI/CD pipeline works end to end. Nothing else matters yet.*				
	Multi-Page Product Marketing Site				
P2	Multi-page marketing site for a fictional SaaS product: homepage, features, pricing, FAQ, and contact. Navigation, reusable layouts, and product messaging copy written from scratch.	Information architecture · Value proposition design · Pricing page structure · Navigation UX · Landing page conversion thinking	CSS Grid · Multi-page site structure · Tailwind CSS introduction · Vanilla JS modals and nav toggle	HTML5 · CSS3 · Tailwind CSS · Vanilla JS · GitHub · Netlify	IA diagram · PRD · Figma wireframe (intro)
	Interactive Product Calculator / ROI Estimator				
P3	Browser-based calculator — ROI estimator, pricing calculator, or productivity impact tool. User inputs, conditional logic, and results display with visual feedback. No backend.	Outcome-based product design · Input validation spec · Business logic documentation · User feedback state design	DOM manipulation · Forms and input validation · Client-side conditional logic · Basic JS error handling	Vanilla JS · HTML5 · CSS3 · GitHub	Business logic spec · PRD · Edge case log
	■ *Products communicate value through measurable outcomes. This project internalizes that principle.*				
	Responsive Case Study Template				
P4	Reusable HTML/CSS case study page template with five structured sections: problem, research, solution, metrics, tradeoffs, and learnings. This becomes the format used for every future portfolio project.	Five-part case study structure · Content hierarchy · PM artifact presentation · Visual storytelling discipline	Responsive layout · Print-friendly CSS · Semantic HTML sectioning · Typography system · Figma layout mockup	HTML5 · CSS3 · Figma · GitHub · Netlify	Case study template · Figma mockup · PRD
	Product Teardown & Redesign Case Study				

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
	★ PORTFOLIO CANDIDATE — Product Teardown & Redesign				
P5	Select a widely-used app with visible UX friction. Conduct a heuristic evaluation, document the friction points, design a data-backed redesign in Figma, and build a static HTML prototype of the improved flow.	UX critique methodology · Heuristic evaluation · Competitive analysis · Problem validation · OKR definition for design changes · Success metric design	Figma high-fidelity wireframes · Component-driven design · Static HTML prototype · axe-core accessibility audit intro	Figma · HTML5 · CSS3 · axe-core · GitHub	UX audit report · Figma mockup · Redesign PRD · OKRs · Case study
	■ *First portfolio milestone candidate. PM thinking is fully visible before a single line of backend code exists.*				
	Public API Data Dashboard				
P6	Dashboard consuming a public REST API (weather, finance, GitHub, movies). Multiple chart types, loading states, error states, and empty states handled explicitly. No backend required.	API dependency risk documentation · Data visualization principles · Dashboard UX hierarchy · Third-party SLA awareness	Fetch API · Async/Await · REST API consumption · JSON parsing · Chart.js · Error and loading state patterns	Vanilla JS · Fetch API · Chart.js · OpenWeatherMap or CoinGecko API · GitHub	API integration spec · Error state matrix · Dashboard wireframe · PRD
	Multi-Page Portfolio Site with Vanilla JS Routing				
P7	Rebuild thepmdev.com foundation as a content-rich multi-page site with JS-driven navigation, animated page transitions, dynamic content injection, GA4, and Open Graph meta tags.	IA design · Navigation strategy · SEO fundamentals · Content hierarchy · Personal brand positioning	History API / hash routing · JS module pattern · CSS transitions · Meta and OG tags · GA4 snippet integration	Vanilla JS modules · History API · CSS transitions · Google Analytics 4 · GitHub · Netlify	IA diagram · Navigation spec · SEO checklist · PRD
	■ *Closes Phase I. Before touching React, understand what a framework is actually solving.*				

Phase II · P8 – P16 FRONT-END FRAMEWORK — React, Component Architecture & Managed Auth

Graduate from document-oriented thinking to component-oriented thinking. React is the dominant front-end framework in product companies — master it deeply before adding a custom backend. This phase introduces headless CMS for content management and, critically, managed user authentication via Supabase or Firebase at P15. Managed auth is the fastest path to a working login system and the recommended entry point for user accounts. Custom auth from scratch is built in Phase III (P19). PM skills introduced: design systems, component spec writing, content modeling, migration planning, identity lifecycle design, and A/B hypothesis framing.

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
	React Component Library & Design System				
P8	Reusable component library: Button, Input, Card, Modal, Toast, Badge, Dropdown. Each component documented with props, states, and usage examples. Pure UI primitives — no app logic.	Component spec writing · Design token documentation · Reusability criteria · Accessibility requirements per component	React functional components · Props and PropTypes · CSS Modules · TypeScript introduction · Vite project setup	React · Vite · CSS Modules · TypeScript · axe-core	Component spec · Design token inventory · Accessibility checklist · PRD
	React Task Board (Kanban) with State Management				
P9	Trello-style Kanban board: create, edit, delete, and move tasks between columns. Tag filtering, priority levels, due dates, and LocalStorage persistence across sessions.	CRUD interaction design · Prioritization logic · Data model definition · Workflow design	useState · useReducer · useEffect · HTML Drag-and-Drop API · Conditional rendering · Component composition · LocalStorage	React · Vite · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS · LocalStorage	Data model spec · Interaction spec · PRD
	■ *Kanban is the most PM-relevant interface pattern. Build it and understand it from the inside.*				
	Product Requirements Manager App				
P10	Web app for writing lightweight PRDs: problem statement, user personas, requirements, success metrics, risks, and open questions. Structured forms, Markdown editor, and template system.	PM artifact design · Structured data modeling · Reusable template patterns · Information hierarchy in forms	React controlled forms · Markdown editor integration · Template pattern · TypeScript interfaces · LocalStorage schema	React · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS · Marked.js or react-md-editor · LocalStorage	PRD template spec · Data model · PRD
	■ *A PM building a PRD tool understands the artifact from the inside out.*				
	Now / Next / Later Roadmap Builder				
P11	Roadmap planning app: create initiatives, assign RICE or MoSCoW priority scores, estimate effort, group by Now/Next/Later horizon, and export as image or PDF for stakeholder sharing.	RICE framework · MoSCoW framework · ICE scoring · Roadmap structure · Tradeoff communication · Stakeholder presentation design	React Router v6 · Dynamic route params · Recharts or Chart.js timeline · Client-side PDF/image export · TypeScript	React · React Router · Recharts or Chart.js · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS	Prioritization framework comparison doc · Roadmap spec · Export spec · PRD

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
	■ *Use RICE to prioritize this project's own feature backlog. PM exercise embedded in the build.*				
	Product Metrics Dashboard Prototype				
P12	Dashboard showing product KPIs: signups, activation rate, retention, churn, conversion, and MRR. Mock JSON data. Multiple chart types. AARRR funnel visualization with drop-off callouts.	KPI definition · AARRR funnel design · Dashboard layout hierarchy · Metric interpretation · Data storytelling	Recharts · Custom hooks · Memoization · Skeleton loading states · TypeScript generics · Mock data structure	React · Recharts · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS · Mock JSON	KPI definition doc · Dashboard spec · AARRR map · PRD
	■ *Foundation for every future analytics case study. Metrics defined here reappear across the journey.*				
	Global State Management — Shopping Cart				
P13	Product listing, cart, and simulated checkout flow. Add/remove/update quantities, persist cart to LocalStorage, and global state via Zustand. Simulate payment confirmation UI.	Cart UX patterns · State persistence strategy · Checkout flow design · Payment failure state UX · Plan upgrade/downgrade analogy	Zustand or Redux Toolkit · Context API comparison · Selector patterns · Middleware · Optimistic UI	React · Zustand or Redux Toolkit · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS	State architecture diagram · Cart flow spec · PRD
	Next.js SSR/SSG Content Site with Headless CMS				
P14	Content-driven site powered by a headless CMS (Contentful or Sanity). Static generation for performance, dynamic pages where needed, SEO-optimized meta tags, and image optimization.	Content modeling · SEO strategy · Static vs dynamic routing tradeoffs · Non-technical stakeholder tooling design	Next.js · Static Site Generation · Server-Side Rendering · Contentful or Sanity · next/image · next/head SEO	Next.js · Contentful or Sanity · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS · Vercel	Content model spec · SEO checklist · Static vs dynamic decision doc · PRD
	User Accounts & Authentication — Managed (Supabase/Firebase)				
	■ **AUTH MILESTONE**				
P15	Full user account system via managed cloud auth: signup, login, logout, protected routes, password reset, email verification, and user-scoped data isolation. First working login in the product.	Auth flow documentation · Identity lifecycle design · Onboarding trust signals · Security requirement writing · Account lifecycle (create, verify, reset, delete)	Supabase Auth or Firebase Auth · Protected routes in Next.js · Row-level security intro · Real-time DB subscriptions · Email verification flow	Supabase or Firebase · Next.js · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS	Auth flow diagram · Identity lifecycle doc · Security requirements · PRD
	■ *AUTH MILESTONE — Earliest point in the roadmap where full user accounts are live. Managed service removes infrastructure burden so focus stays on the product experience.*				
	Component Testing with Jest and React Testing Library				

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
P16	Full test suite for P9 or P13. Unit tests per component, integration tests for key user flows, coverage report generated and interpreted, and a CI test run on GitHub Actions.	Acceptance criteria as test cases · QA strategy documentation · Release confidence definition · CI gate criteria	Jest · React Testing Library · Test coverage tooling · Mocking · GitHub Actions CI pipeline introduction	Jest · React Testing Library · GitHub Actions · TypeScript	Test strategy doc · Coverage report · CI pipeline spec · PRD
	■ *Closes Phase II. Acceptance criteria traced directly to tests. A PM who understands this writes better requirements.*				

Phase III · P17 – P24 | BACKEND & DATABASE — Custom APIs, Persistence & Full-Ownership Auth

Cross the full-stack line. Build custom APIs, connect to real relational and document databases, and implement authentication from scratch — giving complete ownership of every layer of the stack. P19 is the custom JWT auth project: bcrypt hashing, refresh token rotation, HTTP-only cookies, and full password reset. This is the phase where the product transitions from prototype to a real, deployable full-stack application. File uploads, cloud storage, and transactional email are introduced as production-grade product capabilities. PM skills introduced: API contract design, data modeling, ERD documentation, technical requirement writing, system architecture diagramming, and migration planning.

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
	Custom REST API with Node.js and Express				
P17	Standalone REST API for the P9 Task Manager. Full CRUD endpoints, request validation middleware, error handling, rate limiting, and a complete Postman collection with documentation.	API contract documentation · Endpoint design · HTTP status code strategy · Versioning rationale · Rate limit requirement	Node.js · Express.js · RESTful routing · Middleware chain · Postman collection · dotenv · express-validator	Node.js · Express.js · Postman · dotenv · express-validator	API contract doc · Postman collection · Rate limit spec · PRD
	PostgreSQL Database Integration with Prisma ORM				
P18	Replace LocalStorage with a custom PostgreSQL database. Schema design, Prisma migrations, relational queries, indexed lookups, and a formal ERD documenting all entity relationships.	Data model documentation · Migration planning · Relational vs flat data tradeoffs · Schema versioning strategy	PostgreSQL · Prisma ORM · Database migrations · Schema design · SQL fundamentals · Indexed queries	PostgreSQL · Prisma · Node.js · Express.js · pgAdmin	ERD (Entity-Relationship Diagram) · Migration log · PRD
	■ *SQL is a non-negotiable PM hard skill. Every data-fluent PM can write a basic SELECT query.*				
	Custom User Auth — JWT, Refresh Tokens & Password Reset				
	■ AUTH MILESTONE				
P19	Full custom authentication system built from scratch: email/password registration, bcrypt hashing, JWT access tokens, refresh token rotation, HTTP-only cookies, protected routes, and password reset via email token.	Custom auth flow documentation · Session UX design · Security requirement writing · Trust and privacy spec · Token lifecycle policy	JWT · bcrypt · Refresh token rotation · HTTP-only cookies · Role-based route protection · SendGrid password reset email	JWT · bcrypt · Node.js · Express.js · PostgreSQL · SendGrid	Auth flow diagram · Token lifecycle doc · Security requirements · PRD
	■ *AUTH MILESTONE — Full-ownership custom auth. Every decision is explicit: token expiry, rotation, cookie policy, and reset flow.*				
	Full-Stack Integrated App — React + Node + PostgreSQL				

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
P20	First fully integrated full-stack application. React frontend consumes the custom authenticated Node/Express/PostgreSQL API. Users register, log in, and manage their own data end to end.	Full system architecture documentation · Cross-layer dependency mapping · End-to-end user journey · Deployment runbook	Full-stack integration · CORS configuration · Environment variable management · Frontend + backend co-deployment · Render or Railway hosting	React · Node.js · Express · PostgreSQL · Prisma · Render or Railway	System architecture diagram · Full-stack PRD · Deployment runbook
	■ *First project where every layer is yours. The debugging will teach more than any tutorial.*				
	Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) + Admin Dashboard				
P21	Extend P20 with admin and standard user roles. Admin dashboard with user management, content moderation, system settings, and an audit log of all admin actions. Permission-gated UI components.	Permission matrix design · Admin UX patterns · Internal tooling design · Audit trail requirements · Operational visibility	RBAC middleware · Permission-gated rendering · Audit logging pattern · Admin UI · Soft delete	Node.js · PostgreSQL · React · JWT with role claims · Prisma	Permission matrix · Admin flow spec · Audit log spec · PRD
	File Uploads, Cloud Storage & Attachments				
P22	Users upload files and images as task attachments. Cloud storage via AWS S3 or Supabase Storage. File type and size validation, presigned URLs for secure access, and download/preview UI.	File handling UX · Storage cost modeling · Upload failure state design · File lifecycle and retention policy	AWS S3 or Supabase Storage · Multer · Presigned URLs · File validation middleware · Client-side preview	AWS S3 or Supabase Storage · Multer · Node.js · React	File handling spec · Storage cost estimate · Lifecycle policy · PRD
	Transactional Email System with SendGrid				
P23	Transactional emails: welcome on registration, password reset, task assignment notification, weekly digest, and account deletion confirmation. HTML templates, delivery tracking, and bounce handling.	Transactional email spec · User communication design · Deliverability requirements · Email metrics: open, bounce, unsubscribe	SendGrid API · HTML email templating · Webhook handling for delivery events · Unsubscribe management · Email preview testing	SendGrid · Node.js · Express.js · HTML email templates · Prisma	Email flow spec · Template inventory · Delivery metrics spec · PRD
	■ *Every automated message is a product decision. Communication design is a PM craft.*				
	NoSQL Document Store — Activity Feed with MongoDB				
P24	Activity feed and event log system using MongoDB. Flexible document schema, pagination, filter and sort by event type. Structured SQL vs NoSQL tradeoff analysis documented as a PM artifact.	SQL vs NoSQL decision framework · Schema flexibility cost-benefit · Data architecture documentation	MongoDB · Mongoose · Document schema design · Aggregation pipeline · Indexed queries · Cursor-based pagination	MongoDB · Mongoose · Node.js · Express.js	SQL vs NoSQL decision doc · Schema design · Aggregation query library · PRD
	■ *Closes Phase III. The decision doc produced here is a real PM technical artifact.*				

Phase IV · P25 – P30 — PRODUCT COLLABORATION & TEAM FEATURES

Build the multi-user collaborative product layer — the feature set that separates a personal tool from a team product. This phase builds directly on the custom authentication established in Phase III (P19). Teams, workspaces, email invitations, and org-level role management extend the auth system into a full identity hierarchy. Real-time collaboration via WebSockets, threaded comments, a notification center, a public customer feedback portal, and full-text search complete the collaboration feature set. By the end of this phase the product is a functioning team collaboration platform. PM skills introduced: multi-tenant data modeling, team onboarding flows, permission hierarchies, customer discovery systems, voice-of-customer synthesis, and search product design.

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
	Team Workspaces, Invitations & Org-Level Auth				
	■ **AUTH MILESTONE**				
P25	Users create workspaces, invite team members via email with token-validated links, and collaborate on shared projects. Org-level RBAC (owner, admin, member), workspace switching, and member management UI.	Multi-user data model design · Team onboarding flow · Invitation UX · Permission hierarchy documentation · Org-level identity design	Organization/team schema · Email invitation with token validation · RBAC at org level · Workspace context middleware · Scoped API queries	Node.js · PostgreSQL · Prisma · React · SendGrid · JWT	Team data model diagram · Invitation flow spec · Permission hierarchy matrix · PRD
	■ *AUTH MILESTONE — Team and org layer. Extends P19 custom auth into a full organizational identity hierarchy.*				
	Comments, @Mentions & Threaded Discussions				
P26	Threaded comments on tasks and projects. @mention notifications, emoji reactions, comment edit/delete with audit trail, and comment-level permission control based on org role.	Collaborative UX design · Notification trigger taxonomy · Mention and threading interaction spec · Comment lifecycle policy	Nested comment schema · @mention parsing · Notification trigger events · Soft delete with audit · React rich text basics	Node.js · PostgreSQL · Prisma · React · WebSockets (intro)	Comment system spec · Notification trigger map · PRD
	Real-Time Collaboration with WebSockets				
P27	Live updates pushed to all workspace members without refresh. User presence indicators, typing status, and live task state synchronization across all active users. Operational status panel.	Real-time UX spec · Presence design · Message delivery guarantee definition · Concurrent user experience mapping · Latency tolerance rules	WebSockets · Socket.io · Room-based event broadcasting · Presence tracking · Optimistic UI patterns · Redis pub/sub introduction	Socket.io · Node.js · PostgreSQL · React · Redis (pub/sub intro)	Real-time spec · Presence flow diagram · Latency tolerance rules · PRD
	In-App Notification Center				
P28	Multi-channel notification system: in-app notification bell with unread badge, email notifications per event type, user preference controls per channel, and notification analytics.	Notification taxonomy design · Opt-in/opt-out UX · Notification fatigue strategy · Multi-channel preference management spec	Notification schema · Unread count aggregation · WebSocket-driven badge updates · Per-user preference storage · SendGrid channel	Node.js · PostgreSQL · Socket.io · React · SendGrid	Notification taxonomy · Preference matrix · Fatigue analysis doc · PRD

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
	■ *Notification strategy is one of the most user-trust-sensitive decisions a PM makes.*				
	Customer Feedback & Feature Request Portal				
P29	Public-facing portal where users submit feedback, vote on feature requests, and track status. Admins categorize, respond, change status, and link requests directly to roadmap items.	Voice-of-customer system design · Feedback synthesis methodology · Qualitative data loop · Roadmap transparency · Customer discovery documentation	Voting and ranking system · Status workflow state machine · Public vs authenticated views · Admin moderation queue · Email notification on status change	Next.js · PostgreSQL · Prisma · React · SendGrid · Auth	Feedback taxonomy · Prioritization workflow spec · Customer discovery log · PRD
	■ *Strong PM relevance. The artifacts here are real discovery outputs, not simulations.*				
	Full-Text Search Across Workspaces				
P30	Search across tasks, projects, comments, and documents within a workspace. Typo tolerance, faceted filtering, relevance ranking, search analytics (no-results rate, top queries), and zero-results handling.	Search relevance definition · Zero-results handling strategy · Search analytics interpretation · Discoverability UX · Search as a retention feature	Algolia or PostgreSQL full-text search · Index schema design · Relevance tuning · Faceted filtering · Search event tracking	Algolia or PostgreSQL FTS · Node.js · React · TypeScript	Search spec · Relevance criteria doc · Zero-results strategy · PRD
	■ *Closes Phase IV. Search is a product strategy decision masquerading as a technical one.*				

Phase V · P31 – P40 — PAYMENTS, MONETIZATION & GROWTH ANALYTICS

Build products that make money and measure themselves. Stripe integration, subscription lifecycle management, feature flags, behavioral analytics, A/B testing, lifecycle email automation, SQL analytics, and a complete customer data platform. This phase produces the strongest PM portfolio candidates: metric optimization projects and GTM case studies. Every project in this phase adds a measurable business capability to the product built in Phases III and IV. PM skills introduced: pricing model design, funnel analysis, activation metric definition, A/B experiment design, statistical significance, LTV/CAC modeling, event taxonomy, and CDP architecture.

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
	Stripe One-Time Payment Integration				
P31	One-time payment processing via Stripe Checkout or Elements. Webhook handling for payment confirmation, failure, and refund events. Purchase confirmation email. Idempotency handled correctly.	Payment flow documentation · Checkout UX design · Payment failure state handling · PCI compliance awareness · Webhook event taxonomy	Stripe API · Stripe Webhooks · Idempotency keys · Payment intent lifecycle · Webhook signature verification	Stripe · Node.js · Express.js · React · SendGrid	Payment flow diagram · Webhook event spec · Failure handling matrix · PRD
	Subscription Billing — SaaS Tier Model				
P32	Full subscription lifecycle: free trial, plan selection (free/pro/team), upgrade/downgrade, cancellation, reactivation, and invoice history. Stripe Customer Portal integrated. Plan entitlement middleware enforced.	Pricing tier design · Subscription lifecycle mapping · Plan entitlement logic · Churn definition · LTV/CAC fundamentals · Billing UX edge cases	Stripe Subscriptions · Stripe Customer Portal · Billing webhooks · Entitlement middleware · Plan upgrade/downgrade API logic	Stripe · Node.js · PostgreSQL · Prisma · React	Pricing tier spec · Subscription lifecycle diagram · Entitlement matrix · Billing edge case log · PRD
	■ *Subscription logic is the most common PM domain in SaaS. Own every edge case completely.*				
	Pricing Page, Packaging Design & Upgrade Prompts				
	★ PORTFOLIO CANDIDATE — Cross-Functional GTM: Pricing Launch				
P33	Pricing comparison page with psychological pricing design, contextual in-product upgrade prompts, billing portal link, and a documented A/B test variant of pricing copy structure.	Pricing psychology · Packaging strategy · Conversion optimization · Upgrade prompt placement rationale · Plan comparison UX · Pricing page audit	Feature-gated UI components · Contextual upgrade modals · Pricing page A/B variant structure · Stripe plan switching UI	React · Stripe · Tailwind CSS · TypeScript	Pricing rationale doc · Upgrade prompt spec · A/B hypothesis · PRD
	■ *Portfolio candidate. Pricing decisions require engineering, marketing, sales, and legal alignment.*				
	Feature Flags with LaunchDarkly				

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
P34	Feature flags across the product: gradual rollout, kill switch, per-user targeting, percentage rollout, and beta group management. Flag inventory documented and lifecycle managed.	Rollout strategy design · Flag lifecycle management · Percentage rollout risk assessment · Beta group definition · Kill switch rationale	LaunchDarkly SDK · Flag targeting rules · A/B flag variants · Flag cleanup discipline · CI/CD integration for flag evaluation	LaunchDarkly · React · Node.js · TypeScript	Flag inventory · Rollout strategy doc · Flag lifecycle policy · PRD
	Product Analytics — Behavioral Event Taxonomy				
P35	Instrument the product with behavioral event tracking. Define and implement the full event taxonomy. Build activation funnel, retention cohorts, and feature adoption dashboard. Identify first major drop-off point.	Event taxonomy design · Funnel definition · Activation metric selection · AARRR framework application · Retention cohort analysis	Mixpanel or Amplitude SDK · Event tracking implementation · Funnel visualization · Cohort analysis · Segment.io introduction	Mixpanel or Amplitude · Segment.io (optional) · React · Node.js	Event taxonomy doc · Funnel spec · AARRR dashboard · Activation definition · PRD
	■ *The event taxonomy is the most important data decision a PM makes. Get it right early.*				
	Onboarding Flow Redesign & Activation Optimization				
	★ PORTFOLIO CANDIDATE — Metric Optimization: Activation Funnel				
P36	Multi-step onboarding wizard with progress tracking. Measure drop-off at each step using analytics. Redesign the highest-dropout step. Document before/after activation rate comparison as a PM case study.	Onboarding funnel analysis · Activation metric definition · Drop-off hypothesis generation · Iteration decision documentation · PM impact story construction	Multi-step wizard UI · Onboarding progress persistence · Event tracking per step · Feature flag for variant · Before/after data comparison	React · Node.js · Mixpanel or Amplitude · LaunchDarkly · PostgreSQL	Onboarding funnel doc · Drop-off analysis · Redesign rationale · Before/after metrics · Case study
	■ *Portfolio candidate. 'How I improved activation by X%' is the clearest PM impact story a candidate can tell.*				
	A/B Testing — Hypothesis to Statistical Significance				
P37	Design and run a controlled A/B test on a live feature (CTA copy, onboarding step, or pricing prompt). Hypothesis, sample size calculation, variant via LaunchDarkly, results analysis, and rollout/rollback decision memo.	A/B test design discipline · Statistical significance · MDE calculation · Null hypothesis framing · Rollout/rollback decision memo	LaunchDarkly variants · Chi-square or z-test basics · Sample size calculator · Results visualization in analytics platform	LaunchDarkly · Mixpanel or Amplitude · React · Statistics fundamentals	A/B test design doc · Statistical significance calculation · Results report · Rollout decision memo · PRD
	Lifecycle Email & Behavioral Retention System				

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
P38	Behavioral email sequences triggered by user actions: welcome, onboarding incomplete reminder, feature adoption nudge, weekly digest, reactivation campaign, and churn risk alert. Segmented by behavioral cohort.	Lifecycle messaging strategy · Retention loop design · User segmentation · Email metrics (open, click, unsubscribe, downstream conversion) · Churn prevention framework	SendGrid or Resend · Cron job scheduling · Behavioral trigger logic · BullMQ job queue · User segment SQL queries	SendGrid or Resend · BullMQ · Redis · Node.js · PostgreSQL · Cron	Lifecycle email map · Segment definitions · Retention loop diagram · Email metrics spec · PRD
	SQL Analytics — Direct Database Querying for PMs				
P39	Write SQL queries directly against the product database to answer business questions: funnel completion rates, cohort retention, MRR by plan, churn by segment, and feature adoption by role.	Data question formulation · SQL as PM self-service tool · Analyst collaboration simulation · KPI storytelling from raw data · Dashboard design	Advanced SQL · Window functions · CTEs · Aggregation queries · Metabase or Redash dashboard · pgAdmin query execution	PostgreSQL · Metabase or Redash · SQL · pgAdmin	SQL query library · Self-service KPI dashboard · Data question log · PRD
	■ *A PM who writes SQL does not wait three days for an analyst to answer a question.*				
	Customer Data Platform — Segment.io + Data Export				
P40	Integrate Segment.io as a central event router connecting analytics, email, and CRM. Add CSV and PDF data export for users and admin reporting. Single tracked event fires to all downstream tools simultaneously.	CDP architecture · Data governance fundamentals · Single source of truth design · Export UX · Admin reporting dashboard design	Segment.io source and destination config · Identity resolution · Event routing rules · CSV/PDF export libraries · BullMQ for async export	Segment.io · Node.js · React · Mixpanel · SendGrid · pdf-lib or similar	CDP architecture diagram · Event routing map · Export spec · Admin reporting spec · PRD
	■ *Closes Phase V. Every growth-stage company uses a CDP. Understanding it makes you a better PM immediately.*				

Phase VI · P41 – P47 REAL-TIME, SCALE & ADVANCED INFRASTRUCTURE

Build products that operate at concurrency and scale. Background job processing, Redis caching and performance optimization, an integrations marketplace with OAuth2 and webhook reliability, internal sales enablement as a GTM artifact, a full WCAG 2.2 AA accessibility audit, internationalization and localization, and a PWA for mobile reach. This phase produces enterprise-grade technical fluency and a second strong GTM portfolio candidate. PM skills introduced: SLA writing, latency tolerance definition, integration marketplace design, OAuth2 UX, GTM kit construction, WCAG compliance documentation, i18n product strategy, and offline-first product design.

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
	Background Job Queue with BullMQ and Redis				
P41	Async background processing: email delivery, report generation, image processing, and data exports. Job retry logic with exponential backoff, dead letter queue, and admin job status dashboard.	Async vs sync decision framework · Job failure UX · SLA definition for background tasks · Operational status design · Queue as product reliability layer	BullMQ · Redis · Worker processes · Retry/backoff patterns · Dead letter queue handling · Job status WebSocket updates	BullMQ · Redis · Node.js · PostgreSQL · React	Job taxonomy · Failure handling spec · SLA document · PRD
	Redis Caching Layer & Performance Optimization				
P42	Redis caching on high-read endpoints. Cache invalidation strategy, TTL design, cache-hit rate measurement, before/after latency comparison, and Google Lighthouse performance audit with Web Vitals baseline.	Performance requirement writing · Cache strategy documentation · Latency SLA definition · Page speed to conversion rate connection · Performance budget definition	Redis caching · TTL and eviction strategy · Cache invalidation patterns · Google Lighthouse automation · Web Vitals measurement	Redis · Node.js · Google Lighthouse · Postman · pgAdmin	Performance baseline report · Cache strategy doc · Web Vitals dashboard · Performance budget · PRD
	Integrations Marketplace — OAuth2 & Outbound Webhooks				
	★ PORTFOLIO CANDIDATE — GTM: Integrations Platform Launch				
P43	Integration hub connecting to external services (Slack, Google Calendar, GitHub). OAuth2 authorization flows for each integration, outbound webhooks with retry logic, and an integration management UI.	Integration product design · OAuth2 UX flow · Webhook reliability spec · Partner integration documentation · API ecosystem and platform strategy	OAuth2 authorization code flow · Token storage and refresh · Webhook payload handling and retry · Integration state management	OAuth2 · Node.js · PostgreSQL · React · Slack API or Google Calendar API	Integration catalog · OAuth2 flow diagrams · Webhook reliability spec · PRD
	■ *Integrations are a platform strategy decision. This project introduces ecosystem thinking to the PM toolkit.*				
	Internal Sales Enablement Portal				

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
P44	Internal-facing GTM portal: product positioning guides, objection handling scripts, competitive comparison matrices, launch FAQs, customer segment profiles, and demo scripts. Searchable and role-gated.	GTM planning · Sales enablement documentation · Stakeholder alignment artifact creation · Influence without authority · Launch readiness checklist	Next.js · Admin roles · Markdown or CMS content layer · Search integration · Authentication · PDF export	Next.js · PostgreSQL · Prisma · Auth · Markdown · Search	GTM launch kit · Sales enablement guide · Competitive comparison matrix · Launch readiness checklist · PRD
	■ *These artifacts are real GTM deliverables. A hiring manager reviewing this understands cross-functional execution.*				
	WCAG 2.2 AA Accessibility Audit & Full Remediation				
P45	Full WCAG 2.2 Level AA audit of the existing product. Automated audit via axe-core, manual keyboard navigation testing, screen reader testing (NVDA or VoiceOver), color contrast remediation, focus management, and ARIA implementation.	Accessibility as product requirement · WCAG 2.2 compliance documentation · Audit-to-remediation prioritization · Inclusive design principles · Legal risk framing	axe-core automated audit · ARIA roles and labels · Keyboard navigation patterns · Focus management · NVDA or VoiceOver testing · Colour Contrast Analyser	axe-core · NVDA or VoiceOver · Colour Contrast Analyser · React · Node.js	WCAG 2.2 audit report · Remediation priority matrix · Compliance sign-off checklist · PRD
	■ *WCAG 2.2 AA is non-negotiable on all PMD projects. This project builds the formal audit skill.*				
	Internationalization & Localization (i18n / l10n)				
P46	Multi-language support: string externalization, locale switching UI, RTL layout support (Arabic or Hebrew), date/number/currency formatting per locale, and a translation workflow using Crowdin or similar.	Localization requirement writing · Market entry documentation · Translation workflow design · RTL product considerations · Regional pricing strategy	i18next · React-i18next · RTL CSS layouts · Locale-aware number and date formatting · Pluralization rules · Translation file management	i18next · React · Node.js · Crowdin (optional) · Tailwind CSS RTL	Localization spec · Locale support matrix · Translation workflow doc · Market entry rationale · PRD
	Progressive Web App (PWA) — Mobile Bridge				
P47	Convert the existing product to a PWA: service worker for offline caching, install-to-home-screen prompt, Web Push API notifications, app-shell architecture, and a Lighthouse PWA audit.	Offline-first UX requirements · PWA vs native mobile decision framework · Push notification strategy · App install conversion design · Mobile reach without app store	Service Worker API · Cache API and strategies · Web Push API · Manifest.json · Workbox · Lighthouse PWA audit scoring	Service Worker API · Web Push API · Workbox · React · Lighthouse	Offline UX spec · PWA vs native decision doc · Push notification taxonomy · Lighthouse PWA audit · PRD
	■ *Closes Phase VI. PWA is the most cost-effective mobile strategy for a solo product builder at this stage.*				

Phase VII · P48 – P56

AI & MACHINE LEARNING INTEGRATION

Integrate AI as a deliberate product capability — not as a novelty, but as a solution to a defined user problem. OpenAI and Anthropic API integration, structured output design, vector search, RAG pipelines, document analysis, AI chatbots with memory and guardrails, ML model serving, and autonomous agentic workflows. This phase produces the strongest 0-to-1 greenfield portfolio candidates in the entire roadmap. PM skills introduced: AI feature scoping, prompt engineering as product design, hallucination risk documentation, AI cost modeling, responsible AI and content policy writing, model card documentation, and agentic UX design.

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
	OpenAI API — Text Generation Feature Integration				
P48	AI text generation inside an existing product: task description generation, summary creation, or meeting notes. Streaming responses, token tracking, rate limiting, cost monitoring per feature.	AI feature scoping · Prompt as product design · Cost-per-feature analysis · AI failure mode documentation · Human-in-the-loop design	OpenAI API · Streaming responses · Token budgeting · Rate limiting · Error classification · Cost monitoring dashboard	OpenAI API · Node.js · React · TypeScript	AI feature spec · Prompt library v1 · Cost model · Failure mode doc · PRD
	Anthropic Claude API — Structured Output Product				
P49	Product feature using Claude producing structured JSON for downstream consumption. Multi-turn conversation state management, system prompt engineering, output schema validation, and evaluation rubric.	Structured output spec writing · System prompt as product requirement · AI output evaluation criteria · Open-ended vs structured output tradeoffs	Anthropic SDK · System prompts · Multi-turn conversation management · JSON output schema · Zod schema validation · Output regression testing	Anthropic SDK · Node.js · React · TypeScript · Zod	System prompt spec · Output schema · Evaluation rubric · Regression test suite · PRD
	AI PRD Assistant — Greenfield 0-to-1 Product				
	★ PORTFOLIO CANDIDATE — 0-to-1 Greenfield: AI PRD Assistant				
P50	AI assistant that turns vague product ideas into structured PRDs: problem statement, personas, user stories, success metrics, risks, and open questions. Human-in-the-loop editing and versioned output history.	Full PM lifecycle ownership · Product-market fit validation · AI UX design · Prompt engineering as requirement · 0-to-1 product launch plan	OpenAI or Anthropic API · Streaming · Structured output parsing · Version history in PostgreSQL · React rich text editing	Anthropic or OpenAI API · Next.js · PostgreSQL · Prisma · Stripe · TypeScript	Market research · Personas · Full PRD · RICE prioritization · Launch plan · Full case study
	■ *Strongest greenfield candidate. Solves a problem hiring managers recognize and experience personally.*				
	Vector Database & Semantic Search				

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
P51	Embed a document corpus and build semantic search over it. Similarity scoring, hybrid search combining keyword and semantic retrieval, relevance evaluation, and embedding model comparison.	Semantic vs keyword search tradeoffs · Relevance evaluation design · Embedding cost analysis · Search quality metrics	Pinecone or pgvector · OpenAI Embeddings API · Cosine similarity · Hybrid search implementation · Chunking strategy experiments	Pinecone or pgvector · OpenAI Embeddings · Node.js · TypeScript	Search architecture diagram · Relevance evaluation doc · Embedding cost model · Chunking strategy · PRD
	RAG Pipeline — Retrieval-Augmented Generation				
P52	RAG system over a document corpus: ingest, chunk, embed, retrieve, and generate. Document Q&A; with source citations, hallucination mitigation strategy, and context window management experiments.	RAG architecture documentation · Hallucination risk spec · Citation UX design · Grounding strategy · Context window tradeoffs	LangChain or custom RAG pipeline · Vector retrieval · Context window management · Source citation injection · Chunking strategy iteration	LangChain · Pinecone or pgvector · OpenAI or Anthropic · Node.js · TypeScript	RAG architecture diagram · Hallucination mitigation spec · Chunking strategy doc · PRD
	AI Document Analysis Tool				
P53	Upload a PDF or contract. AI extracts structured data (key clauses, dates, parties), generates a summary, answers specific questions, and flags risks. Multi-document side-by-side comparison mode.	Document processing UX · Extraction accuracy definition · Edge case documentation · Confidence scoring design · Human-review trigger design	PDF text extraction · Multimodal input handling · Structured extraction prompts · Confidence scoring · pypdf or pdfplumber	Anthropic or OpenAI API · pypdf · Node.js · React · TypeScript	Extraction spec · Accuracy evaluation rubric · Edge case log · PRD
	AI Chatbot with Memory, Persona & Guardrails				
P54	Persistent AI assistant with conversation memory, defined persona, tool use (web search or calculator), content guardrails, and a structured user feedback loop for quality improvement.	Persona specification · Guardrail requirement writing · Content policy documentation · Feedback loop design · Trust and safety spec	Conversation memory patterns · Tool use / function calling · Content filtering logic · Feedback storage · Conversation history in PostgreSQL	Anthropic or OpenAI API · LangChain or custom · PostgreSQL · React · TypeScript	Persona spec · Guardrail spec · Content policy doc · Feedback loop design · PRD
	ML Predictive Feature — Churn Prediction or Recommendation				
P55	Train and deploy a simple ML model as a product feature: churn prediction or content recommendation. Feature engineering, model evaluation, A/B test against rule-based baseline, and model card documentation.	ML feature requirements writing · Model evaluation criteria · False positive/negative cost analysis · Explainability requirements · Model card as PM artifact	Python · scikit-learn · Feature engineering · Model evaluation metrics (AUC, F1, precision/recall) · FastAPI model serving endpoint	Python · scikit-learn · pandas · FastAPI · PostgreSQL	ML feature spec · Model card · A/B test design · Performance metrics report · PRD
	■ *First Python project. PM must understand model tradeoffs deeply to write good ML requirements.*				
	AI Agent with Tool Orchestration				

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
P56	Autonomous agent that plans, selects tools (web search, code execution, API calls), and completes multi-step tasks with minimal human input. Full observability, tracing, and failure recovery built in from the start.	Agentic product design · Human-in-the-loop decision points · Observability requirements · Failure recovery design · Agentic UX patterns	LangChain agents or custom orchestration · Tool definitions and schemas · Reasoning loop patterns · LangSmith or similar tracing · Error recovery logic	Anthropic or OpenAI API · LangChain · Python or Node.js · LangSmith	Agent architecture diagram · Tool inventory · Observability spec · Failure recovery spec · PRD
	■ *Closes Phase VII. Agentic AI is the current frontier. Placed here deliberately — after deep foundations.*				

Phase VIII · P57 – P66+

PLATFORM, MOBILE & PRODUCTION SCALE

Graduate from product builder to platform thinker. GraphQL API design, cross-platform React Native mobile development, Docker containerization, full CI/CD pipeline automation, multi-tenant SaaS architecture, micro-frontend decomposition, production observability with SLA/SLO documentation, an executive reporting dashboard, an enterprise pricing migration as a GTM capstone, and a full SaaS product launch simulation as the flagship portfolio project. Portfolio milestone projects are assessed and designated during this phase — not before. PM skills introduced: platform and API strategy, mobile product management, infrastructure cost modeling, enterprise documentation, DevOps collaboration, incident response, DORA metrics, and end-to-end launch narrative construction.

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
	GraphQL API with Apollo Server				
P57	Replace or augment REST endpoints with GraphQL. Schema-first design, resolvers, mutations, real-time subscriptions, N+1 optimization via DataLoader, and Apollo Client integration on the frontend.	GraphQL vs REST decision documentation · Schema design as product contract · API versioning strategy · Query efficiency tradeoffs · Client-driven data fetching design	GraphQL · Apollo Server · Resolvers and mutations · DataLoader · Schema-first design · Apollo Client · Subscription handling	GraphQL · Apollo Server · Apollo Client · Node.js · TypeScript	API schema doc · REST vs GraphQL decision memo · Schema governance policy · PRD
	React Native Mobile App — iOS & Android				
P58	Port core product features to iOS and Android via React Native. Navigation, device APIs (camera, location), push notifications via APNs/FCM, offline mode with local storage, and app store submission prep.	Mobile-specific UX requirements · Platform parity decision matrix · App store submission spec · Offline-first product design · Mobile feature gap analysis vs web	React Native · Expo · React Navigation · Device APIs · APNs/FCM push notifications · TypeScript · Offline storage with MMKV	React Native · Expo · TypeScript · React Navigation · Firebase Cloud Messaging	Mobile PRD · Platform parity matrix · App store submission checklist · Push notification spec · PRD
	Docker Containerization & Docker Compose				
P59	Containerize the full-stack application. Multi-container Docker Compose setup: app server, PostgreSQL, Redis, and worker. Production-ready Dockerfile with multi-stage builds and environment variable management.	Infrastructure requirement writing · Environment parity documentation · Deployment risk log · Onboarding simplification via containerization	Docker · Docker Compose · Multi-stage builds · Health checks · Volume management · Environment variable injection	Docker · Docker Compose · Node.js · PostgreSQL · Redis	Deployment architecture diagram · Environment spec · Docker runbook · PRD
	CI/CD Pipeline with GitHub Actions				
P60	Full CI/CD pipeline: automated tests on every PR, build validation, staging deploy, manual production approval gate, rollback procedure documentation, and zero-downtime deploy confirmed.	Release process documentation · Deploy gate criteria · Rollback decision tree · Change management spec · DORA metrics awareness (deployment frequency, MTTR)	GitHub Actions workflow YAML · Test automation in CI · Environment secrets management · Blue-green deployment concept · Branch protection rules	GitHub Actions · Docker · Render or Railway or AWS	CI/CD pipeline diagram · Deploy runbook · Rollback procedure · Gate criteria doc · DORA baseline · PRD
	Multi-Tenant SaaS Architecture				

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
P61	Extend the product to support multiple organizations as tenants. Row-level security for complete data isolation, tenant-scoped API, org-level billing via Stripe, tenant onboarding flow, and tenant admin portal.	Multi-tenancy product scoping · Data isolation requirement writing · Tenant onboarding flow · Per-tenant pricing model · Enterprise sales readiness	PostgreSQL row-level security · Tenant context middleware · Shared schema with tenant_id · Stripe per-tenant billing · Tenant provisioning API	PostgreSQL · Node.js · Prisma · Stripe · React	Tenant architecture diagram · Data isolation spec · Onboarding flow · Tenant pricing model · PRD
	■ *Multi-tenancy is the architectural foundation of every B2B SaaS product.*				
	Micro-Frontend Architecture				
P62	Decompose the frontend into independently deployable micro-frontends via Webpack Module Federation. Shared design system, independent deployment pipelines per team, and cross-team ownership simulation.	Platform architecture documentation · Team topology design · API boundary definition · Cross-team dependency charting · Feature ownership models	Webpack Module Federation · Shared component library across MFEs · Shell application pattern · Independent CI/CD pipelines per module	Webpack Module Federation · React · TypeScript · GitHub Actions	Platform architecture diagram · Team boundary spec · Feature ownership matrix · PRD
	Observability — Logging, Metrics, Alerts & Incident Response				
P63	Production observability stack: structured logging, Sentry error tracking, performance metrics, uptime monitoring, on-call alerting, and a formal incident response runbook with post-mortem template.	SLA and SLO definition · Incident response process design · On-call runbook writing · DORA metrics (MTTR, deployment frequency) · Post-mortem culture	Structured logging (Winston or Pino) · Sentry error tracking · Uptime monitoring (Better Uptime or Pingdom) · Alert threshold design · PagerDuty or similar	Sentry · Datadog or Grafana · PagerDuty or similar · Node.js · GitHub Actions	SLA/SLO doc · Alert threshold spec · Incident runbook · Post-mortem template · PRD
	Executive Reporting & Business Intelligence Dashboard				
	★ PORTFOLIO CANDIDATE — Analytics PM: Executive Dashboard				
P64	Executive-level reporting: activation, retention, churn, MRR, NPS simulation, feature adoption, A/B experiment results summary, and custom SQL-driven report builder. CSV and PDF export.	Executive reporting design · Business intelligence fundamentals · Cohort analysis · Metrics hierarchy (leading vs lagging indicators) · KPI storytelling	Advanced SQL · Metabase or Redash · Custom charting · Cohort analysis queries · Report builder UI · CSV/PDF export	PostgreSQL · Metabase or Redash · Recharts · Node.js · React · SQL	Metrics hierarchy doc · Dashboard spec · SQL query library · Cohort analysis report · PRD
	Enterprise Usage Tracking & Consumption Pricing Migration				
	★ PORTFOLIO CANDIDATE — Cross-Functional GTM: Pricing Migration				

Proj	Scope	PM Growth	Tech Growth	New Tools	Artifacts
P65	Migrate from flat subscription to consumption-based pricing. Usage metering, real-time consumption telemetry, usage alerts, overage billing via Stripe, enterprise pricing negotiation tooling, and full GTM launch kit.	GTM launch kit construction · Internal alignment documentation (Engineering, Sales, Legal, Support) · Pricing migration risk log · Backward compatibility strategy · Post-launch feedback loop	Stripe usage-based billing · Real-time consumption telemetry logging · Usage metering middleware · Backward compatibility API strategy	Stripe Usage-Based Billing · PostgreSQL · Node.js · React · Segment.io	GTM launch kit · Pricing migration spec · Internal FAQ · Sales enablement update · Risk log · PRD
	Full SaaS Product Launch Simulation — Flagship Capstone				
	★ FLAGSHIP PORTFOLIO PROJECT — Full SaaS Capstone				
P66	Synthesize the strongest features into a cohesive production-grade SaaS: landing page, auth, onboarding, AI assistant, roadmap builder, feedback portal, subscription billing, analytics, admin, CI/CD, and complete GTM materials.	End-to-end product lifecycle ownership · Full case study suite construction · Launch narrative writing · Cross-functional artifact production · Business model documentation	Full-stack synthesis · All prior capabilities integrated · Production deployment · Live monitoring · Performance budget met · WCAG 2.2 AA confirmed	Next.js · TypeScript · PostgreSQL · Prisma · Stripe · OpenAI/Anthropic · Mixpanel · Segment · Resend · Vercel · GitHub Actions · Docker · Figma	Complete PMD artifact suite · Case study · Portfolio showcase entry · Launch retrospective
	■ *Threshold is earned, not scheduled. Coach assesses readiness from P55-P65 retrospective quality.*				

RECOMMENDED READING & OFFLINE ASSIGNMENTS — BY PHASE

Phase I–II Foundation & React	• Don't Make Me Think — Steve Krug · UX fundamentals every PM must internalize before building anything • The Pragmatic Programmer — Hunt & Thomas · Developer mindset and craft habits, essential for non-developers • HTML & CSS: Design and Build Websites — Jon Duckett · Visual illustrated entry point to the web • Learning React — Alex Banks & Eve Porcello · React mental model built from first principles
Phase II–III Backend & Auth	• Clean Code — Robert C. Martin · Writing code your future self and teammates will not curse • Designing Data-Intensive Applications — Kleppmann · The PM's database and distributed systems bible • The Phoenix Project — Kim, Behr, Spafford · DevOps and engineering culture through a compelling novel
Phase IV–V Analytics & Growth	• Lean Analytics — Croll & Yoskovitz · AARRR, cohort thinking, and the one metric that matters • Hacking Growth — Ellis & Brown · Systematic growth experimentation from the people who invented it • Trustworthy Online Controlled Experiments — Kohavi, Tang, Xu · A/B testing done rigorously • The Mom Test — Rob Fitzpatrick · How to talk to users without getting lied to
Phase IV–V Product Strategy	• Inspired — Marty Cagan · How the best product teams in the world actually work • Continuous Discovery Habits — Teresa Torres · Opportunity trees and user interview discipline • Competing Against Luck — Christensen · Jobs-to-be-Done theory at full depth • Obviously Awesome — April Dunford · Positioning as a PM discipline — what category are you in?
Phase VI–VII AI, Platform & Scale	• Building Machine Learning Powered Applications — Emmanuel Ameisen · ML from prototype to production • Platform Revolution — Parker, Van Alstyne, Choudary · Network effects and ecosystem design • The Lean Startup — Eric Ries · Build-measure-learn at every stage and every scale
Phase VII–VIII Leadership & Business	• Measure What Matters — John Doerr · OKRs in practice at Google and beyond • Crossing the Chasm — Geoffrey Moore · Technology adoption and the B2B PM challenge • High Output Management — Andrew Grove · Management fundamentals for PMs working with engineers • Thinking in Bets — Annie Duke · Decision-making under uncertainty — the PM's core operating condition
Offline Practice Throughout the Journey	• PM Exercises (pmexercises.com) · Daily product design and metric practice problems — do one per day • Lenny's Newsletter (lennyrachitsky.com) · Best practitioner-written PM content available today • Stratechery (stratechery.com) · Ben Thompson's business and technology strategy — read every piece • Monthly product teardown habit: pick one app per month, write a 500-word friction audit • User interview practice: conduct 2 real user interviews per project using The Mom Test methodology • SQL practice: Mode Analytics SQL Tutorial · 30 minutes per day during Phases III through V

PMD · Artifact #18 · Project Roadmap Architecture v2.1 · May 2026 · Where brilliant ideas become shipped products

PMD · Build-in-Public Content Strategy

Artifact #19 · v1.0 · May 2026 · PMD System · The Atom-to-Architecture Framework

SYSTEM PURPOSE

What this is	The PMD Build-in-Public Content Strategy — the system for converting every project's raw work product into a compounding library of published proof. It operates on a single principle: every decision made during the PMD process is content. The discipline of writing about what was built and why compresses skill development faster than building in silence.
Why it exists	A portfolio without a publishing trail is invisible. This system creates a trail of documented thinking that accumulates across every project. By the time the first portfolio milestone project ships, the publishing record already demonstrates pattern recognition, PM fluency, and technical depth — without waiting for a job offer to prove any of it.
How it integrates	Content generation is not a separate task. It is the final step of every PMD project phase. The retro artifact generates the raw material. The Artifact-to-Draft Pipeline converts that raw material into publishable content. The three-tier distribution system places that content where evaluators look.
The model name	The Atom-to-Architecture Framework — also described as Create Once, Distribute Thrice. Small granular build log posts (atoms) aggregate into insight pillars, which aggregate into executive case studies (architecture). No piece of content is created in isolation.
PMD integration point	This artifact is a permanent PMD system process. Every project from P1 forward generates at least one Tier-1 Build Log post. Every phase group closure generates at least one Tier-2 Insight Pillar. Every portfolio milestone project generates a Tier-3 Executive Case Study.

THE THREE-TIER FRAMEWORK — OVERVIEW

Tier	Name	Length	Cadence	Platform	Primary Goal	CTA
1	**Build Log**	150–300 words or 3–5 threads	2–3× per week	LinkedIn Feed X.com Site Changelog	Velocity & Visibility Profile impressions Search recruiter reach	"Follow for the next update"
2	**Insight Pillar**	600–1,000 words	1–2× per month	Medium Substack LinkedIn Articles	Authority & Depth Domain credibility Network growth	"Subscribe for deeper dives"
3	**Executive Case Study**	1,500–2,500 words visual-heavy	Once per portfolio project	Portfolio site (canonical) Resume attachment	Recruiter conversion Interview booking Hiring manager depth	"Download the full PDF case study"

Tier 1 THE BUILD LOG — Social Proof in Real Time

Voice: Real-time · Transparent · Technical · "The Hustle"

The Build Log is the atomic unit of the entire system. It documents a single, highly granular technical or product decision made during a PMD project phase. It does not need to be polished — it needs to be honest, specific, and publishable within 30 minutes of the decision being made. The raw material comes directly from the PMD project retrospective and decision logs. A Tier-1 post that performs well becomes the seed for a Tier-2 Insight Pillar.

Attribute	Detail
Scope	Single granular decision, trade-off, failure, or micro-observation. One decision per post. No summaries.
Platforms	LinkedIn Feed (Quick Update format) · X.com (thread or single post) · On-site product changelog
SEO & Hooks	Niche technical keywords · Tool tags (e.g., #Supabase #React #NextJS) · 'Building in Public' community hashtags · First 100 characters optimized to stop scrolling
PMD Source	PMD Retrospective artifact · Decision log section · Failure/Pivot log · Session notes

POST STRUCTURE

Section	What to Write
THE CHALLENGE	A crisp one or two sentence hook describing the exact bottleneck or decision point encountered.
CRITERIA & CONSTRAINTS	The technical, time, API, or architectural limits that shaped the decision space.
THE CHOICE	The exact path chosen and the viable alternative that was actively rejected — with explicit rationale.
THE SIGNAL	The positive outcome, metric improvement, or learning point that resulted. Even a failure is a valid signal.

Tier 2 THE INSIGHT PILLAR — The 'How I Think' Series

Voice: Educational · Authoritative · Analytical · "The Analyst & Leader"

The Insight Pillar synthesizes three to five Tier-1 Build Log posts into a single thematic framework article. The shift is from 'I did X' to 'How a PM manages Y.' It demonstrates pattern recognition — the ability to extract a generalizable principle from a set of specific decisions. Insight Pillars are the primary source of LinkedIn profile authority and the primary driver of Medium and Substack readership. A strong Tier-2 article can be de-bulked into five sequential LinkedIn posts over a single week to maximize profile impressions with minimal additional writing effort. This is the Hidden SEO tactic.

Attribute	Detail
Scope	Theme across 3–5 Tier-1 posts. One unifying framework per article. Generalizable to other PMs.
Platforms	Medium · Substack · LinkedIn Articles (canonical) · De-bulked into 5x LinkedIn Feed posts
SEO & Hooks	Mid-tail keywords: 'Product Management for Startups' · 'Scaling Next.js Architecture' · Deep-link CTAs to portfolio
PMD Source	Cluster of 3–5 retrospective entries from one phase or across adjacent phases · Phase-close session summary

POST STRUCTURE

Section	What to Write
COMPELLING TITLE	Format: 'Designing [System Type]: How to Navigate the Trade-offs of [Theme]'
THE HOOK	Why this problem matters to PMs broadly — not just to this project.
THE FRAMEWORK	Three to five clearly-labeled subsections. Each maps one Tier-1 decision to a generalizable principle.
THE TAKEAWAY	An explicit, copyable framework statement. What can another PM do with this tomorrow?

Tier 3 THE EXECUTIVE CASE STUDY — The Closer

Voice: Strategic · High-level · ROI-focused · "The Principal PM"

The Executive Case Study is the primary conversion artifact. It is placed on the portfolio site as the canonical document for every portfolio milestone project. It is attached directly to job applications and shared with recruiters post-screening. It must survive two reading modes simultaneously: a 2-minute recruiter skim using scannable headers and metric callouts, and a 10-minute hiring manager deep dive using detailed architecture sections, tradeoff documentation, and outcome data. Every PMD portfolio milestone project produces one Tier-3 case study. The five-part structure maps directly to the PMD artifact suite already produced during the project's nine-phase cycle.

Attribute	Detail
Scope	Full project lifecycle. Problem through outcome. All tradeoffs documented. Visual-heavy with artifact embeds.
Platforms	Portfolio site (canonical) · Attached to resume · Forwarded to recruiters post-screening
SEO & Hooks	High-intent recruiter keywords · Scannable headers for 2-min skim · Data sections for 10-min deep dive
PMD Source	All nine PMD phase artifacts for the project · Problem Statement · Personas · PRD · Wireframe · Retro · Launch Plan · Measure Plan

POST STRUCTURE

Section	What to Write
EXECUTIVE SUMMARY	Core ROI and metric highlights. What was built, what moved, why it matters. Skim-readable in 90 seconds.
MARKET OPPORTUNITY & PROBLEM VALIDATION	The discovery journey. Research, personas, competitive analysis, and problem framing.
THE ARCHITECTURAL BLUEPRINT	Tech stack choices, database structures, API architecture, and the rationale for each decision.
THE ENGINEERING CRUX & PIVOTS	Where the initial plan failed and how it was steered. Tradeoffs documented explicitly. No sanitizing.
OUTCOMES, ANALYTICS & NEXT STEPS	User metrics, performance data, what was learned, and what Phase 2 would address.

THE ARTIFACT-TO-DRAFT PIPELINE

Raw project notes are the raw material. The PMD artifact suite is the assembly line. The AI generates first drafts. The human refines and publishes. This pipeline converts every PMD project into a content inventory without requiring a separate content creation workflow. Notes from the session, the decision log, the retro, and the phase summary are all eligible inputs. Categorize all raw notes into four buckets before drafting.

FOUR RAW MATERIAL BUCKETS — CATEGORIZE NOTES HERE FIRST

Bucket	What Goes Here	Maps to PMD Artifact	Best Tier Output
Decision Logs	The 'why' behind every tool, architecture, or scope choice. Rejected alternatives documented.	PRD Section 5 · Technical Requirements · Documented Tradeoffs	**Tier 1 & Tier 3**
Failure / Pivot Logs	Moments the plan broke. What failed, what was learned, and the adjustment made.	Retrospective · 'What to improve' · 'Questions still open'	**Tier 1 & Tier 3**
Metric Logs	Before/after comparisons. Performance benchmarks. Conversion changes. Lighthouse scores.	Measure & Iterate Plan · OKR KR tracking · A/B test results	**Tier 2 & Tier 3**
User / Persona Logs	Moments user feedback changed a design decision. JTBD insights. Empathy map observations.	Persona artifact · Empathy Map · JTBD + Design Principles	**Tier 2 & Tier 3**

AI CONTENT EXTRACTION PROMPTS — READY TO USE

Tier 1 — Build Log Generation

System:	Act as an expert Technical Product Manager and executive career coach.
Prompt:	Review the attached raw project notes regarding [Insert Feature/Decision Name]. Extract the single most compelling technical decision or trade-off mentioned. Draft a highly professional, engaging 200-word Build Log post tailored for LinkedIn. Structure it exactly as follows: 1. THE CHALLENGE — A crisp hook describing the bottleneck. 2. CRITERIA & CONSTRAINTS — The technical or timeline limits. 3. THE CHOICE — The decision made vs. what was rejected. 4. THE SIGNAL — The positive outcome or learning point. Keep the voice authoritative, transparent, and direct. Avoid corporate jargon. Use professional technical vocabulary.

Tier 2 — Insight Pillar Generation

System:	Act as a Senior Product Lead and Lead Writer for top tech publications on Medium and Substack.
Prompt:	Read the attached text blocks, which comprise 3 to 5 independent Build Log entries for [Project Name]. Identify the unifying product development theme across these entries. Generate a structured 800-word Insight Pillar article. Use a compelling title following the style: 'Designing [System Type]: How to Navigate the Trade-offs of [Theme Name]'. Include distinct section subheaders, itemized bullet points, and an explicit framework other Product Managers can copy. The conclusion must highlight analytical rigor and a user-first mindset.

Tier 3 — Executive Case Study Generation

System:	Act as an elite Principal Product Manager and Executive Recruiter.

Prompt:	Read all the uploaded PMD project artifacts for [Project Name]: Problem Statement, Personas, Empathy Map, JTBD, PRD, Wireframe, Retrospective, Launch Plan, and Measure & Iterate Plan. Synthesize this data into a comprehensive Executive Product Case Study optimized for a portfolio website. Organize using these sections: — Executive Summary & Core ROI (metric highlights, 90-second skim target) — Market Opportunity & Problem Validation (discovery journey) — The Architectural Blueprint (tech stack, DB structure, API rationale) — The Engineering Crux & Pivots (where the plan failed and how it recovered) — Outcomes, Analytics & Next Steps (metrics, learnings, future roadmap) Tone: leadership language, end-to-end accountability, metrics alignment, strategic execution. No sanitizing of failures — tradeoffs and pivots are the strongest signal.

TIER-1 BUILD LOG ENTRY CHECKLIST — COMPLETE FOR EVERY POST

Copy and complete this checklist for every single Tier-1 Build Log entry. Completing it before writing ensures every post is recruiter-optimized, maps to a PM competency, and is ready for cross-platform distribution. Store completed checklists in the project's docs/ folder alongside the PMD artifact suite.

1 · Core Structural Elements

■ THE CONTEXT — What specific user value or functional mechanism was being built?
■ THE CONSTRAINT — What technical, time, API, or architectural limitation was being fought?
■ THE DECISION — What exact technical path was chosen, and which viable alternative was actively rejected?
■ THE EVIDENCE — Is there an attached artifact? (Code snippet, DB schema, wireframe screenshot, performance metric)

2 · PM Interview Question Alignment

■ Does this post implicitly answer a standard PM interview question?
Examples: 'Tell me about a time you managed technical trade-offs'
'How do you handle feature prioritization under constraint?'
'Describe a time your initial approach failed and what you did'
■ Tag the competency category: Technical Strategy · Discovery · Execution · UX

3 · Distribution Setup

■ Platform hook crafted for LinkedIn — first 100 characters optimized to stop scrolling
■ Platform hook crafted for X.com — thread opener or standalone tweet variant
■ Keywords inserted naturally for cross-platform profile SEO
■ Relevant tool hashtags identified (e.g., #Supabase #React #ProductManagement)
■ Call to Action (CTA) appended at the bottom of each platform variant

4 · Aggregation Tracking

■ This post filed in the correct raw material bucket (Decision / Failure / Metric / User)
■ Running count updated — after 3 posts in the same theme, draft the Tier-2 Insight Pillar
■ Post linked from the on-site project changelog if site is live

THE 40-TOPIC CONTENT MENU — TIER-1 IDEATION

Category A — Technical Strategy & Architecture

Demonstrates that you speak the language of engineering and understand technical trade-offs

01 · Tech Stack Justification — Why a language or framework was chosen for scalability vs. speed
02 · API Design Decisions — Choosing between REST, GraphQL, or WebSockets for specific data models
03 · Database Schema Architecture — Explaining relational logic or document nesting schemas
04 · Security & Identity Management — How authentication, authorization, or data privacy was implemented
05 · Technical Debt Lifecycle — Knowingly choosing a quick fix with a documented refactor strategy
06 · Build vs. Buy Decisions — Third-party API integrations vs. writing proprietary software
07 · Environment Parity — Strategy for maintaining Dev, Staging, and Production consistency
08 · Automated Testing Matrix — Why specific unit, integration, or E2E tests were prioritized
09 · Containerization Logic — The why and how of Docker for environment stability
10 · Performance Optimization — Pinpointing a system latency bottleneck and deploying the fix

Category B — Product Discovery & Validation

Proves that you build things that solve verified problems — not just software built blindly

11 · Problem Statement Refinement — How the underlying problem evolved after user or data research
12 · Persona Boundary Conditions — A user scenario that directly changed a core feature's logic
13 · Competitor Gap Analysis — A feature added or removed based on thorough market benchmarking
14 · Assumption Mapping Matrix — Identifying and de-risking the single most critical MVP assumption
15 · User Journey Optimization — The structural logic behind a multi-step onboarding flow
16 · Feature Prioritization Rigor — Using RICE, MoSCoW, or Kano to aggressively cut MVP scope
17 · Unhappy Path & Edge Cases — How systemic recovery models were built for errors and edge cases
18 · Qualitative Feedback Loops — When early user feedback completely inverted a UI hypothesis
19 · Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD) Map — Articulating the exact underlying customer job a feature accomplishes
20 · MVP Hard Constraints — Defining the precise boundary where Minimum safely meets Viable

Category C — Execution & Process (SDLC)

Focuses on operational efficiency, agile practices, and the ability to ship robust products safely

21 · Git Workflow Protocols — Branch naming, trunk protection, and pull request review systems
22 · CI/CD Pipeline Breakdown — Deployment automation structure and pipeline break post-mortems
23 · Documentation Strategy — Clean README, internal wikis, or OpenAPI/Swagger spec design
24 · Sprint Retrospective Analytics — What self-imposed velocity metrics taught during iterations
25 · Dependency Risk Management — Handling a broken, outdated, or insecure open-source package
26 · Bug Triage Matrix — How Severity vs. Priority is defined systematically during crunch phases
27 · Efficiency Tooling Choices — Why specific IDE extensions, CLI agents, or scripts were integrated
28 · State Management Logic — Managing complex reactive states (multiplayer sync, global cart)
29 · Schema & Data Migrations — Logical steps taken to migrate production databases without data loss
30 · Release Notes & Changelogs — Translating technical PR lists into value-driven user changelogs

Category D — Design & User Experience (UX)

Showcases ability to bridge technical architecture and human interaction

31 · Visual System Hierarchy — Why specific UI aesthetics align with user psychology
32 · Information Architecture (IA) — How a dashboard was organized to minimize cognitive load
33 · Accessibility Guardrails (a11y) — Concrete actions taken to meet WCAG 2.2 AA standards
34 · The Empty State Paradigm — Designing high-engagement layouts for zero-data views
35 · Graceful Error Messaging — Transforming system errors into actionable, reassuring user copy
36 · Micro-interactions — Small visual responses built to delight users and anchor habits
37 · Cross-Platform Constraints — Responsive layout trade-offs between desktop and mobile views
38 · Typography & Eye-Tracking — Using text weights and visual anchors to drive CTA conversion
39 · Microcopy & Taxonomy — How navigation naming decisions reduced user confusion or churn
40 · Contextual Iconography — Using universal design indicators to remove language/cultural friction

DISTRIBUTION & PUBLISHING CALENDAR

Tier	Cadence	Operational Focus	LinkedIn Strategy	CTA
1 · Build Log	2–3× per week	Profile impressions · Search recruiter velocity · Niche technical keywords · Community hashtags	Post directly to LinkedIn Feed as Quick Update. First 100 characters must stop the scroll.	'Follow for the next update'
2 · Insight Pillar	1–2× per month	Domain authority · Backlinks · Network credibility · Mid-tail SEO keywords	Publish on Medium/Substack as canonical. Then de-bulk into 5 sequential LinkedIn Feed posts over one week. This is the Hidden SEO tactic.	'Subscribe for deeper dives'
3 · Case Study	Once per portfolio project	Recruiter conversion · Hiring manager depth · High-intent keywords · Resume attachment	Publish on portfolio site as canonical. Share LinkedIn post linking to it. Attach PDF version to job applications and recruiter follow-ups.	'Download the full PDF case study'

THE HIDDEN SEO TACTIC — LinkedIn Profile Authority

For recruiters, the most important SEO is not Google — it is LinkedIn. A recruiter visiting a LinkedIn profile sees recent activity and judges engagement before reading the resume. The tactic: After publishing a Tier-2 Insight Pillar article on Medium or Substack, extract five distinct sub-points from it and publish each as a separate LinkedIn Feed post over five consecutive days. Each post links back to the full article. The result: A recruiter visiting the profile during that week sees five consecutive days of high-quality product thinking. The profile reads as active, deeply invested, and expert-level — from a single article written once.

PMD SYSTEM INTEGRATION — MANDATORY RULES

Every P1–Pn project	Generates at least one Tier-1 Build Log post. The post is drafted at phase close using the session retro as raw material. Minimum: one post per project. Target: one post per completed phase within the project.
Every phase group close	After completing a phase group (e.g., end of Phase II at P16, end of Phase IV at P30), aggregate the Tier-1 posts from that group and draft one Tier-2 Insight Pillar. The pillar identifies the unifying theme across the group's decisions.
Every portfolio milestone project	Produces one Tier-3 Executive Case Study. The case study is drafted after the project's Phase 9 (Measure & Iterate) is complete and at least 30 days of post-launch data is available. No portfolio project is considered complete without a published Tier-3 case study.
Raw material filing	All session notes are categorized into the four Artifact-to-Draft buckets (Decision / Failure / Metric / User) at the close of every session. Filed in docs/content-log/ within the project repository alongside the PMD artifact suite.
The panic word applies	If content creation begins to feel like a blocker rather than a by-product, invoke 'too much' and the coach will narrow to one single Tier-1 post from the most recent session. Content does not block shipping. Shipping always comes first.

PMD · Artifact #19 · Build-in-Public Content Strategy v1.0 · May 2026 · Where brilliant ideas become shipped products

PMD · Project Selection & Kickoff Protocol

Artifact #20 · v1.1 · May 2026 · PMD System · Applies to every project P1 through Pn

PURPOSE OF THIS PROTOCOL

What this is	The structured process that fires before Phase 1 of every new project. It establishes the project's north star — the what and why — before a single artifact is drafted or a single line of code is written. It replaces the blank page with a puzzle. It converts activation paralysis into forward motion.
Why it exists	Without a kickoff protocol, every project begins with the same disorienting moment: scope uncertainty, tool setup anxiety, and the absence of a clear ignition point. This protocol eliminates that moment by design. The project does not start with a task list. It starts with a problem to solve.
The core mechanic	Puzzle-framing triggers intrinsic motivation by appealing to the problem-solver identity. The specific skills and tools required for this project are introduced by the coach as clever solutions to the problem — named explicitly but framed as what they make possible, not what they demand. The user encounters those tools again during Phase 5 PRD, where they become owned requirements.
Project scope — not phase scope	This protocol is scoped to an individual project — P019, P063, P145 — not to a categorical phase. Phase context may appear as orientation background within the Project Context Brief, but the brief itself is always anchored to the specific project's problem and goals. A project number is the unit of work. A phase is a grouping of units.
When it runs	Once per project. Always before Phase 1 Discovery fires. The output is the project's North Star Document — a single locked artifact that every subsequent phase refers back to when scope questions arise.
Design principle	From JTBD Artifact #5, Design Principle 1: One prompt, one answer, one step. This protocol delivers exactly one question at a time. The next step only appears after the current one is answered.

PROTOCOL OVERVIEW — FIVE STEPS

Step	Name	Who leads	Output	Time
1	**Project Context Brief**	Coach delivers	Project-specific goals, skill targets, and tool set framed as outcomes	5 min
2	**The Ignition Prompt**	Coach delivers User responds	Three project options presented. User selects, adapts, or proposes alternative.	10–20 min
3	**Project Evaluation**	Coach + User	Selected project scored against four criteria. Classification and deployment track locked.	10 min
4	**North Star Document**	Coach drafts User approves	One-page locked north star: what, why, success definition, constraints, deployment track.	10 min

5	**Kickoff Checklist**	User completes	Repository initialized, tools confirmed, content log created, Phase 1 ready to fire.	10 min

Coach delivers	**Step 1 — Project Context Brief**

Before the ignition prompt fires, the coach delivers a brief orientation to the specific project being kicked off — not to the phase category it belongs to. The brief is anchored to this project's number, problem space, and goals. Phase context may appear as a one-sentence orientation — for example, 'This project sits within the collaboration layer of Phase IV' — but the brief immediately narrows to the project itself. The brief answers three questions for this specific project: What capability does this project build that the previous project did not have? What does the product look like when this project is done that it does not look like right now? And what are the one or two new skills and tools this project is specifically designed to introduce? Crucially: skills and tools are named explicitly and introduced by the coach — not hidden or withheld. The user cannot independently identify 'WebSockets' as the solution to a real-time presence problem without prior exposure. The coach names the tool, explains what it makes possible, and frames it as the clever solution to the problem the project is trying to solve. The user then encounters those tool names again in Phase 5 PRD, where writing them as technical requirements makes them owned rather than assigned.

PROJECT CONTEXT BRIEF — TEMPLATE

Project number & phase context	State the project number (e.g. P019) and one sentence of phase orientation if relevant: 'P019 sits within Phase III — the first time the product owns its own authentication layer.' Phase context is background, not the focus. The brief is always about this project.
The capability gap	Before this project, the product cannot [X]. After this project, it can [X]. The gap may reference phase-level capability where it adds context — e.g. 'This closes the gap between a managed auth service and full ownership of every token, cookie, and reset flow — the core challenge of Phase III's backend ownership arc.' But the gap is always stated at the project level.
What it makes possible	Two or three concrete outcomes a real user can experience — or a hiring evaluator can see — that were not possible before this project. Framed as outcomes, not features or tools.
Skills and tools introduced	Name the new skills and tools explicitly. For each, give one sentence: what it is, what problem it solves, and why it is the right tool for this project's specific challenge. Example: 'WebSockets — a persistent two-way connection between browser and server — is what makes real-time updates possible without the user refreshing the page.' The user will write these into the PRD technical requirements in Phase 5.
Connection to prior project	One sentence on what this project builds on from the previous one. Reinforces the compounding nature of the journey. Makes each project feel like progress, not a restart.

Coach delivers · User responds	**Step 2 — The Ignition Prompt**

We need to create a project that [solves this specific problem / builds this capability]. Here are three options that could work: Option A — [Project concept: different domain] Option B — [Project concept: different domain] Option C — [Project concept: different domain] Which of these sounds most appealing to you? Do you have a fourth or fifth option to suggest? How could your chosen option be commercialized or genuinely help others?

IGNITION PROMPT — DESIGN MECHANICS	
Why three options	Three options prevents the blank page without creating false constraint. If none of the three resonate, the fourth or fifth option the user generates is always more intrinsically motivated than a coach-assigned project. The coach's three options are puzzle seeds, not mandates.
Options differ by domain	The three options must address meaningfully different problem spaces and user types — not just different names for the same concept. A project exploring real-time collaboration for writers, a project tracking live sports data, and a project showing live inventory updates are three genuinely different puzzles that all happen to require WebSockets. Domain choice drives motivation.
Skills and tools appear in the prompt	The Project Context Brief already named the new skills and tools. The ignition prompt reinforces them naturally by embedding them in the problem framing: 'This project needs to push live updates to every connected user the moment something changes — that's the real-time challenge WebSockets is built to solve.' The tool is the hero of the solution, not an item on a prerequisites list.
Why the commercialization question	The commercialization question fires a second ignition layer by connecting the project to real-world relevance immediately. For someone with business fluency and product vision, 'how could this genuinely help others' is an identity-level motivator, not a hypothetical. It also surfaces portfolio potential early — before any work is done.
What the coach prepares	Before delivering the ignition prompt, the coach reviews the roadmap scope and tools for this specific project position, then drafts three concepts that all satisfy the project's required skill and tool targets. Preparation takes five minutes. The prompt should feel effortless to receive.

Coach + User

Step 3 — Project Evaluation

Once a project concept is selected or proposed, it is scored against four criteria before it is locked. This is a ten-minute conversation, not a form. The coach asks each question, the user responds, and both agree before moving to Step 4. Step 3 also locks the deployment track — Portfolio/Public or Learning/Internal — which determines which checklist items apply in Step 5.

THE FOUR EVALUATION CRITERIA

Criterion	The Question	Pass	Fail → Action
1 Stretch Fit	Does this project introduce the skills and tools identified in the Project Context Brief — without requiring capabilities from phases not yet reached?	Introduces phase tools. Builds on prior tools as foundation.	Too advanced: simplify the concept or defer it to a later project slot.
2 Stall Risk	Is the scope small enough to maintain momentum — completable without triggering the overwhelm loop?	Feels like a stretch. Does not feel like a wall.	Too large: identify the MVP slice. Document the rest as a future project or iteration.
3 Classification	Would a hiring evaluator feel this project's problem is relevant to their company? Or is this primarily a skill-building exercise?	Portfolio: evaluator-relevant. Showcased on thepmdev.com.	Learning: internal only. Valuable but not publicly showcased. Document the classification.
4 Commercial Potential	Is there a real-world user who would benefit from this product? Could it be monetized, open-sourced, or productized — even hypothetically?	A real person with a real problem. Commercialization path imaginable.	No clear user: rephrase the problem or select a different concept from the ignition options.

DEPLOYMENT TRACK DECISION — LOCKED AT STEP 3

Classification determines the deployment track. Not every project requires a public deployment. Internal learning projects are built, documented, and committed to GitHub — but do not require their own domain or hosted environment. This decision is locked here and drives which checklist items apply in Step 5.

Track	When it applies	Deployment required	thepmdev.com
Portfolio / Public	Project classified as Portfolio · OR · project is commercializable and warrants public access · OR · project is explicitly designated as a standalone showcase	Yes — Netlify or equivalent. CI/CD pipeline connected. Custom domain or thepmdev.com subdirectory.	Showcased on thepmdev.com when full launch trigger is met (P0 v2 + 3 portfolio projects live).
Learning / Internal	Project classified as Learning · AND · not designated as a public showcase · AND · no commercialization path is being actively pursued	No public deployment required. Code committed to GitHub. Local dev environment sufficient.	Not showcased publicly. May be referenced in the PMD journey log or reading tracker as evidence of progression.

thepmdev.com Living Repository Appendix — P0 v2 Backlog Item: A dedicated navigation section on thepmdev.com housing all projects as a living appendix — showing titles, project numbers, phase groupings, skills demonstrated, and build dates — would make internal learning projects publicly visible as evidence of progression without requiring individual deployments. This is logged as a P0 v2 backlog item and does not block any current project.

Coach drafts · User approves

Step 4 — The North Star Document

The North Star Document is the single locked artifact establishing the project's what and why before Phase 1 fires. It is one page. It is approved before any other artifact is created. Every subsequent phase refers back to it when scope questions arise. It is not a PRD — the PRD comes in Phase 5 and expands on the north star. It is directional, not prescriptive. It is the flag on the mountain. Phase 1 Discovery is the first step toward it.

NORTH STAR DOCUMENT — TEMPLATE

Field	What to write
Project number & name	The project number from the roadmap (e.g. P019) and the name chosen during the ignition prompt. The name describes the product or problem — not the tools used to build it.
The problem being solved	One paragraph written in the voice of the user, not the builder. Who has this problem, what is the cost of not solving it, and why does it persist today.
The proposed solution	One paragraph stating what this project builds and — equally important — what it does not build. The 'does not build' line is the scope boundary. It prevents drift through all nine phases.
Definition of done	Three to five specific, observable conditions that mean this project is complete. Not 'the app works.' Concrete and testable: 'A user can create an account, log in from a mobile browser, see their dashboard, and log out without errors or broken layout.'
Skills and tools targeted	The three to five capabilities this project is specifically designed to build, framed as 'after this project I will be able to [X].' The specific tools named in the Project Context Brief are listed here by name. These become the technical requirements section of the Phase 5 PRD.
Classification	Learning (internal only) or Portfolio (showcased on thepmdev.com). Locked here. Reclassification requires documented rationale in the retrospective.
Deployment track	Portfolio/Public or Learning/Internal. Locked at Step 3. Determines which checklist items apply and whether a public deployment is required.
Commercial potential note	One sentence on who this could serve beyond the builder and how. Learning projects include this line to keep product thinking active throughout the build.
Coaching mode	The calibration level confirmed for this project per the PMD coaching scale. Stated explicitly so both coach and user begin from the same expectation.
Content log initialized	Confirmation that docs/content-log/ exists in the repository and the four Artifact-to-Draft bucket files are ready: decisions.md · failures.md · metrics.md · user-insights.md

User co
mplete
s
before
Phase 1
fires

Step 5 — Kickoff Checklist

The kickoff checklist is the gate between the protocol and Phase 1 Discovery. It takes ten minutes and makes the project real. Every unchecked box is a future blocker surfaced before it becomes a stall. The checklist has two tracks. Complete the Universal section for every project. Then complete either the Portfolio/Public track or the Learning/Internal track based on the deployment decision locked in Step 3.

UNIVERSAL — Every project, every track

- ■ New GitHub repository created with name matching the North Star Document
- ■ README.md initialized with project number, name, phase context, and one-line problem statement
- ■ NOTES.md created for open items, technical debt, and deferred decisions
- ■ docs/ folder created with subdirectories: current/ · archive/ · content-log/
- ■ Content log bucket files initialized: decisions.md · failures.md · metrics.md · user-insights.md
- ■ .gitignore configured for this project's expected tech stack
- ■ First commit pushed — repository is live on GitHub
- ■ PMD_SKILL.md and current session summary confirmed available for this session context
- ■ North Star Document filed to docs/current/ and approved by both user and coach
- ■ All new tools required for this project confirmed installed or accounts created
- ■ .env.example created with all required variable names — no values committed
- ■ Classification locked: Learning or Portfolio
- ■ Deployment track locked: Portfolio/Public or Learning/Internal
- ■ Coaching mode confirmed for this project
- ■ First Tier-1 Build Log post drafted for the project selection decision itself

PORTFOLIO / PUBLIC TRACK — Complete when deployment track = Portfolio/Public

- ■ Netlify (or equivalent hosting) connected to GitHub repository
- ■ CI/CD pipeline confirmed: local commit → GitHub push → auto-deploy → live URL
- ■ Custom domain or thepmdev.com subdirectory configured and resolving correctly
- ■ Google Analytics 4 measurement ID installed in index.html or _app
- ■ Microsoft Clarity tracking script installed
- ■ WCAG 2.2 Level AA compliance confirmed as a Phase 7 build requirement
- ■ thepmdev.com showcase slot noted in P0 v2 backlog once full launch trigger conditions are met

LEARNING / INTERNAL TRACK — Complete when deployment track = Learning/Internal

- ■ Local development environment confirmed running without errors
- ■ GitHub repository is the deployment artifact — no public hosting required
- ■ Project noted in the PMD journey log and skills tracker as in-progress
- ■ If commercialization potential emerges during the build: flag for reclassification in retrospective

PMD SYSTEM INTEGRATION — SKILL.MD ADDITION

The following rules are added to PMD_SKILL.md immediately after the COACHING RULES — PERMANENT section and before COACHING CALIBRATION. They are permanent and non-negotiable.

Before every project	The five-step Project Selection & Kickoff Protocol runs in full. No project begins at Phase 1 without a completed North Star Document and a passed Kickoff Checklist. Applies to P1 through Pn without exception.
Project Context Brief	The brief is scoped to the individual project — P019, P063 — not the categorical phase. Phase context may appear as a one-sentence orientation. The brief is always anchored to this specific project's number, problem, and goals.
Skills and tools are named	The coach names all new skills and tools explicitly in the Project Context Brief. Each is framed as the clever solution to a specific problem the project faces. The user writes them into the Phase 5 PRD technical requirements, which is when ownership transfers from coach to builder.
The ignition prompt rule	Three meaningfully different project options presented — different domains, not just names. User selects, adapts, or proposes a fourth or fifth. Coach never assigns unilaterally. Commercialization question is always included.
Deployment track	Portfolio/Public or Learning/Internal. Locked at Step 3. Portfolio projects require full CI/CD deployment and WCAG 2.2 AA. Learning projects require only a GitHub repository and local dev environment. Reclassification requires documented rationale in the retrospective.
North Star is scope authority	When scope questions arise during any phase, the North Star Document is the authority. The PRD in Phase 5 expands on it — it does not contradict it.
Reference artifact	Artifact #20 · Project Selection & Kickoff Protocol v1.1 · May 2026

VERSION HISTORY

Version	Key changes	Date
v1.0	Initial protocol — five steps, ignition prompt, four evaluation criteria, North Star Document template, kickoff checklist	May 2026
v1.1	Five clarifications applied: (1) Renamed Phase Context Brief to Project Context Brief — scoped to individual project number, not categorical phase. (2) Capability Gap field updated to clarify phase language is permitted as orientation context only. (3) Skills and tools are now explicitly named by coach and framed as problem solutions — not hidden — with PRD Phase 5 as the ownership transfer point. (4) Deployment made conditional — two-track checklist: Portfolio/Public and Learning/Internal. thepmdev.com living appendix logged as P0 v2 backlog item. (5) Panic word references removed throughout.	May 2026

PMD · Artifact #20 · Project Selection & Kickoff Protocol v1.1 · May 2026 · Where brilliant ideas become shipped products

Sentiment Journey Diary

System Spec & Data Schema · v1.1 · May 2026

1 · What This Artifact Is

The Sentiment Journey Diary is a data-driven emotional tracking system for the PMD project journey. It captures quantitative confidence ratings alongside rich qualitative retrospective content for every project — then generates dynamic visual infographics from that data on demand.

The core output is a horizontal hiker-on-a-path infographic: a small village at the left (P0 origin), a distant mountain summit at the right (long-term vision), and an emotional terrain between them showing peaks and valleys mapped to real project outcomes. The path scales dynamically — narrow views focus on 3–5 current projects with full detail, wide macro views show the complete arc with summary-level content.

The infographic serves multiple output contexts: thepmdev.com homepage feature, branded blog post hero banners, social post assets, and — in a later phase — an embedded interactive React component on a dedicated Journey page.

2 · Two-Layer Architecture

Layer	File	Purpose	Grows over time?
Data source	`PMD_Sentiment_Data.json`	Structured log of every project entry — ratings, retro bullets, metadata	Yes — one entry added per project close
Generator	`generate_sentiment_infographic.py`	Reads the JSON, renders the infographic at requested zoom level, outputs PDF + PNG	No — script is stable, re-run on demand

The data source and the generator are intentionally separate. The JSON grows with every project. The generator is stateless — it reads whatever entries exist and renders the requested view. Re-running the generator at any time produces an updated infographic without modifying historical data.

3 · PMD_Sentiment_Data.json — Complete Schema

All cells wrapped in Paragraph objects per locked PDF pattern. The JSON schema below defines every field, its type, and its purpose.

v1.1 changes from v1.0: peak_valley removed — terrain derived from confidence_score by generator. exceeded_expectations and fell_short consolidated into self_assessment object — eliminates redundancy with worked_well and tricky. content_log_items and next_project_intent promoted to required — optional fields do not get filled. duration field added — project cadence is evaluator-relevant signal. horizon array added — provides the forward-looking runway the infographic needs to render upcoming projects.

Field	Type	Required	Description
schema_version	string	Yes	Schema version identifier — e.g. '1.1'. Increment when fields are added.
generated	string	Yes	ISO 8601 date of last data update — e.g. '2026-05-01'.
journey.origin	string	Yes	Label for the path start — e.g. 'P0 · Portfolio Shell'.
journey.destination	string	Yes	Label for the distant summit — e.g. 'Full-Stack PM · Hired'.
projects[]	array	Yes	Ordered array of completed project entries. One object per project, in completion order.
projects[].id	string	Yes	Unique project identifier — e.g. 'P0', 'P1'.
projects[].name	string	Yes	Short display name — e.g. 'Portfolio Shell'.
projects[].phase_range	string	Yes	Phase span completed — e.g. 'Phases 1–9'.
projects[].completed	string	Yes	Completion date — e.g. 'May 2026'.
projects[].duration	string	Yes	How long the project took — e.g. '6 weeks', '3 sessions'. Cadence is evaluator-relevant signal on the macro view.
projects[].classification	string	Yes	'portfolio' or 'learning'. Locked at kickoff Step 3.
projects[].confidence_score	number	Yes	Honest post-project score — 0.0 to 10.0. Primary elevation driver. Generator derives peak/valley/neutral from this — no manual terrain field needed.
projects[].headline	string	Yes	One-line emotional headline — displayed at the path node in both zoom modes.
projects[].worked_well[]	string[]	Yes	What worked well. 2–4 items. Source: retrospective.
projects[].tricky[]	string[]	Yes	What was harder than expected. 2–3 items.
projects[].proud_of[]	string[]	Yes	What you are most proud of. 1–3 items.
projects[].self_assessment{}	object	Yes	Replaces separate exceeded_expectations and fell_short fields. Two subfields: exceeded[] (1–2 items where output surpassed your own bar) and fell_short[] (1–2 items, honest). Consolidated to avoid duplication with worked_well and tricky.

projects[].showcase_candidate	boolean	Yes	true / false — is this a thepmdev.com showcase candidate?
projects[].showcase_note	string	Yes	One sentence — why it is or is not a showcase candidate. Renamed from showcase_rationale for brevity.
projects[].skills_gained[]	string[]	Yes	Discrete skills gained or materially strengthened this project.
projects[].tools_used[]	string[]	Yes	Tools used — e.g. 'ReportLab', 'React', 'GA4'.
projects[].content_log_items[]	string[]	Yes — min 1	Tier-1 content atoms captured this project. Promoted to required — optional fields do not get filled. Minimum one entry per project.
projects[].next_project_intent	string	Yes	One sentence — intended next project at time of this entry. Promoted to required. The gap between intent and actuals over time is meaningful data.
horizon[]	array	Yes — min 1	Forward-looking array of upcoming projects. Provides the runway ahead that the infographic renders as a dashed projected path. Each entry: id, name, status ('queued' or 'in-progress'). Distinct visual treatment from completed solid path nodes.

4 · Example Entry — P0 Seed Record

The JSON file is seeded with P0 at first creation. Every project close adds one entry. The structure below is the complete P0 seed — replace placeholder values with actuals when populating PMD_Sentiment_Data.json.

```
{
"schema_version": "1.1",
"generated": "2026-05-01",
"journey": {
"origin": "P0 · Portfolio Shell",
"destination": "Full-Stack PM · Hired"
},
"projects": [
{
"id": "P0",
"name": "Portfolio Shell",
"phase_range": "Phases 1-9",
"completed": "May 2026",
"duration": "approx. 8 sessions",
"classification": "portfolio",
"confidence_score": 1.0,
"headline": "System exists. First product shipped. The path begins.",
"worked_well": [
```

```
"PMD system held structure across all 9 phases without breaking down",
"WCAG 2.2 AA delivered non-negotiably",
"Session summaries enabled clean context handoff every session"
],
"tricky": [
"Sketch image positioning required many iteration cycles",
"Responsive CSS took longer than estimated"
],
"proud_of": [
"Shipped a live URL from a standing start",
"16 approved artifacts across 9 phases — complete cycle"
],
"self_assessment": {
"exceeded": [
"PMD SKILL.md created — system now self-documenting and portable"
],
"fell_short": [
"Draft-first protocol not active at P0 — coach led rather than user"
]
},
"showcase_candidate": true,
"showcase_note": "Demonstrates complete 9-phase process and live deployment.",
"skills_gained": ["ReportLab PDF generation", "WCAG 2.2 AA", "CI/CD via Netlify"],
"tools_used": ["HTML/CSS/JS", "ReportLab", "GA4", "Microsoft Clarity", "Netlify"],
"content_log_items": ["P0 launch build log — X.com pinned post"],
"next_project_intent": "P1 — TBD after six system additions complete"
}
],
"horizon": [
{ "id": "P1", "name": "TBD — pending kickoff", "status": "queued" }
]
}
```


---

5 · Infographic Visual Specification

5.1 · Layout — Horizontal Hiker Path

The infographic is horizontal landscape orientation. Left anchor: small village in foothills — labeled with journey.origin. Right anchor: distant mountain summit — labeled with journey.destination. Between them: a winding path whose elevation is driven by each project's confidence_score. Higher score = path rises. Lower score = path dips. The hiker avatar sits at the most recent project node.

5.2 · Zoom Levels — Two Output Modes

Mode	Projects shown	Detail level	Primary use case

Narrow · Current State	Previous 3–5 projects + next 1–2 projected	Full retro bullets visible at each node. Headline + worked well + tricky + proud of.	Homepage feature · Blog hero banner · Social post asset
Wide · Macro Arc	All projects from P0 forward	Headline only at each node. Confidence score visible. Full terrain arc readable.	Phase group retrospective · Executive Case Study visual · Journey page

5.3 · Path Node Anatomy

Element	Source field	Rendered as
Node marker	confidence_score (derived)	Circle — green when score >= 6.0 · amber when 3.0–5.9 · muted red when < 3.0. Terrain derived by generator — no manual peak_valley field.
Project label	id + name	'P1 · Project Name' — above or below node depending on path elevation
Duration badge	duration	Small label at node — e.g. '6 weeks'. Visible in wide macro mode.
Emotional headline	headline	Italic caption beneath project label
Confidence score	confidence_score	Small badge — e.g. '1.0 / 10' — visible in both zoom modes
Retro bullets	worked_well · tricky · proud_of	Compact bullet list at node — narrow mode only
Portfolio star	showcase_candidate	★ marker on node when true
Horizon nodes	horizon[]	Upcoming projects rendered as dashed path with lighter treatment — visually distinct from completed solid nodes.

6 · Output Files — Naming Convention

File	Format	Purpose
PMD_SentimentJourney_Narrow_vX.X .pdf	PDF	Print-quality narrow view. Source for PNG export.
PMD_SentimentJourney_Narrow_vX.X .png	PNG	Web asset · blog hero banner · social post · homepage feature

PMD_SentimentJourney_Wide_vX.X.pdf	PDF	Print-quality macro arc view. Archive and case study attachment.
PMD_SentimentJourney_Wide_vX.X.png	PNG	Web asset for journey page and retrospective posts
PMD_Sentiment_Data.json	JSON	Permanent data source. Lives at repo root. Never deleted.
generate_sentiment_infographic.py	Python	Generator script. Reads JSON. Accepts --mode narrow|wide --version flags.

7 · React Interactive Component — Scoped for Later

An interactive React version of the Sentiment Journey Diary is scoped but not yet built. It reads from the same PMD_Sentiment_Data.json data source. No new data entry is required when the component is eventually built — the JSON is the single source of truth for both outputs.

Feature	Description	Priority
Zoom slider	Toggle between narrow current-state view and wide macro arc	P0 v2 build
Node hover / tap	Expand full retro content for any project node on interaction	P0 v2 build
Live data binding	Reads PMD_Sentiment_Data.json directly — updates automatically when new entries are added	P0 v2 build
Export trigger	Button to trigger PDF/PNG snapshot generation from current view state	Later
Journey page embed	Component embedded on dedicated thepmdev.com/journey page	P0 v2 build

8 · Process — When and How to Update

Trigger	Action	Who
Project close — every project P0 through Pn	Add one entry to PMD_Sentiment_Data.json. Complete all required fields. Commit to repo.	PM Dev + Coach
Infographic needed for web or social use	Run generate_sentiment_infographic.py with --mode narrow. Output PNG to assets/.	PM Dev
Phase group retrospective	Run generator with --mode wide. Attach PDF to retrospective artifact.	PM Dev + Coach

Schema change required	Update schema_version in JSON. Document field addition in PMD_DECISION_LOG.md. Update this spec to match.	Coach
React component build triggered	Reference this spec Section 7 and PMD_Sentiment_Data.json schema. No data migration required.	PM Dev

9 · Locked Decisions

Decision	Detail
Data format	JSON — best tool for structured, extensible, machine-readable data. Not .md for convenience.
Numeric rating retained	confidence_score 0.0–10.0 kept as quantitative backbone. Boring in isolation. Powerful with qualitative context.
Terrain derived from score	peak_valley removed as manual field. Generator derives node colour and terrain elevation from confidence_score. Eliminates data integrity risk from score/terrain contradictions.
self_assessment consolidation	exceeded_expectations and fell_short consolidated into self_assessment.exceeded and self_assessment.fell_short. Removes redundancy with worked_well and tricky.
content_log_items required	Promoted from optional to required, minimum one entry. Optional fields do not get filled. Content strategy is a permanent process obligation.
next_project_intent required	Promoted from optional to required. Intent vs actuals gap over time is meaningful data on the macro view.
duration required	Added as required field. Project cadence is evaluator-relevant signal on the wide macro view.
horizon array added	Forward-looking array provides the upcoming 1–2 project runway the infographic needs. Dashed visual treatment distinguishes projected from completed path.
showcase_note rename	showcase_rationale renamed to showcase_note — signals a working note, not a formal document.
PDF priority over React	PDF/PNG snapshots built first — immediate use cases confirmed. React component scoped and preserved.
Single data source	PMD_Sentiment_Data.json drives both PDF generator and future React component. No duplication.

Permanent retention	Every entry retained permanently. Wide view depends on complete unbroken history.
P() helper — all table cells	Per locked PDF pattern. All table cell content wrapped in Paragraph. VALIGN TOP. Never plain strings.

Version History

Version	Key change	Date
v1.0	Initial spec — system architecture, full JSON schema, infographic spec, zoom levels, output naming, React scope, process triggers	May 2026
v1.1	Six schema corrections applied after coach review: peak_valley removed (terrain derived from confidence_score); exceeded_expectations + fell_short consolidated into self_assessment object; content_log_items and next_project_intent promoted to required; duration field added; horizon array added for forward-looking runway; showcase_rationale renamed to showcase_note	May 2026